जब तक आपको यह परीक्षण पुस्तिका खोलने को न कहा जाए तब तक न खोलें

T.B.C.: FIAS-SFG26 **परीक्षण पुस्तिका अनुक्रम**

परीक्षण पुस्तिका

सामान्य अध्ययन

A

पूर्णांक : 102.5 **समय: एक घंटे**

अनुदेश

1. परीक्षा प्रारम्भ होने के तुरन्त बाद, आप इस परीक्षण पुस्तिका की पड़ताल अवश्य कर लें कि इसमें कोई बिना छपा, फटा या छूटा हुआ पृष्ठ अथवा प्रश्नांश, आदि न हो। यदि ऐसा है, तो इसे सही परीक्षण पुस्तिका से बदल लीजिए।
2. **कृपया ध्यान रखें कि OMR उत्तर-पत्रक में, उचित स्थान पर, रोल नम्बर और परिक्षण पुस्तिका अनुक्रम A, B, C या D को, ध्यान से एवं बिना किसी चूक या विसंगति के भरने और कूटबद्ध करने की जिम्मेदारी उम्मीदवार की है। किसी भी प्रकार की चूक/विसंगति की स्थिति में उत्तर -पत्रक निरस्त कर दिया जाएगा ।**
3. इस परीक्षण पुस्तिका पर साथ में दिए गए कोष्ठक में आपको अपना अनुक्रमांक लिखना है। परीक्षण पुस्तिका पर **और कुछ न** लिखें।

नाम:
ईमेल:
मोबाइल:

4. इस परीक्षण पुस्तिका में **60** प्रश्नांश (प्रश्न) हैं। प्रत्येक प्रश्नांश **अंग्रेज़ी और हिंदी** में छपा है। प्रत्येक प्रश्नांश में चार प्रत्युत्तर (उत्तर) दिए गए हैं। इनमें से एक प्रत्युतर को चुन लें, जिसे आप उत्तर-पत्रक पर अंकित करना चाहते हैं। यदि आपको ऐसा लगे कि एक से अधिक प्रत्युत्तर सही हैं, तो उस प्रत्युत्तर को अंकित करें जो आपको सर्वोत्तम लगे। किसी भी स्थिति में, प्रत्येक प्रश्नांश के लिए **केवल एक ही** प्रत्युत्तर चुनना है।
5. आपको अपने सभी प्रत्युत्तर अलग से दिए गए उत्तर-पत्रक पर ही अंकित करने हैं। उत्तर-पत्रक में दिए गए निर्देश देखिए।
6. **1 से 50 तक प्रत्येक 2 अंक के हैं तथा प्रश्न 51 से 60 तक प्रत्येक 0.25 अंक के हैं।**
7. इससे पहले कि आप परीक्षण पुस्तिका के विभिन्न प्रश्नांशों के प्रत्युत्तर उत्तर-पत्रक पर अंकित करना शुरू करें, आपको प्रवेश प्रमाण-पत्र के साथ प्रेषित अनुदेशों के अनुसार कुछ विवरण उत्तर-पत्रक में देने हैं।
8. आप अपने सभी प्रत्युत्तरों को उत्तर-पत्रक में भरने के बाद तथा परीक्षा के समापन पर केवल उत्तर-पत्रक अधीक्षक को सौंप दें। आपको अपने साथ परीक्षण पुस्तिका ले जाने की अनुमति है।
9. कच्चे काम के लिए पत्रक परीक्षण पुस्तिका के अंत में संलग्न है।
10. **गलत उत्तरों के लिए दंड :**

अभ्यर्थी द्वारा चिह्नित गलत उत्तरों के लिए पेनल्टी होगी, सिवाय प्रश्न 51 से 60 के, जिनमें गलत उत्तर के लिए कोई पेनल्टी नहीं है।

(i) प्रत्येक प्रश्न के लिए चार वैकल्पिक उत्तर हैं। उम्मीदवार द्वारा प्रत्येक प्रश्न के लिए दिए गए एक गलत उत्तर के लिए प्रश्न हेतु नियत किए गए अंकों का एक-तिहाई दंड के रूप में काटा जाएगा।

(ii) यदि कोई उम्मीदवार एक से अधिक उत्तर देता है, तो इसे गलत उत्तर माना जाएगा, यद्यपि दिए गए उत्तरों में से एक उत्तर सही होता है, फिर भी उस प्रश्न के लिए उपर्युक्तानुसार ही, उसी तरह का दंड दिया जाएगा।

(iii) यदि उम्मीदवार द्वारा कोई प्रश्न हल नहीं किया जाता है, अर्थात उम्मीदवार द्वारा उत्तर नहीं दिया जाता है, तो उस प्रश्न के लिए कोई दंड नहीं दिया जाएगा।

नोट: प्रश्न का उत्तर दें तथा अभ्यर्थी आत्मविश्वास स्तर (100% / 75% / 50% / 0%) का उपयोग करके उत्तर के प्रति अपनी निश्चितता का स्तर दर्ज कर सकते हैं। आप प्रत्येक प्रश्न के नीचे उपयुक्त आत्मविश्वास स्तर का चयन कर सकते हैं। इससे उन प्रश्नों की पुनरावृत्ति (रिवीजन) में सहायता मिलेगी, जिनमें उत्तर सही होने के बावजूद आप अनिश्चित थे।

जब तक आपको यह परीक्षण पुस्तिका खोलने को न कहा जाए तब तक न खोलें

Q.1) A decrease in tax to GDP ratio of a country indicates which of the following?
1. Slowing economic growth rate.
2. Less equitable distribution of national income.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.
a) 1 only
b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2
d) Neither 1 nor 2

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.2) A travel website advertises hotel rooms at ₹2,000 per night. However, during the booking process, additional charges for taxes, internet access and amenities are revealed, raising the total price to ₹2,750. This practice misleads consumers about the final cost and limits informed decision-making. This is the description of which of the following practices?
a) Bait and switch
b) Price gouging
c) Drip pricing
d) Basket sneaking

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.3) With reference to various financial Institutions in India, consider the following information:

Name of the Institution	Established	Works under
I. Economic Intelligence Council (EIC)	by Executive Order of the Government	Ministry of Finance
II. Financial Intelligence Unit - India (FIU-IND)	by Executive Order of the Government	Ministry of Home Affairs
III. Serious Fraud Investigation Office (SFIO)	under a Law enacted by Parliament	Ministry of Corporate Affairs

In how many of the above rows is the given information correctly matched?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) All the three
d) None

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.4) A tax system is characterized as a 'Progressive Tax Structure' when the income elasticity of tax is:
a) Equal to 1
b) Between 0 and 1
c) Greater than 1
d) Equal to 0

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.5) Consider the following statements regarding Cess in India:

Statement I: The greater the share of tax revenue of the Union from cesses, the lower will be the tax revenues distributed to the states by the Union.

Statement II: Cess is excluded from the purview of the divisible pool of taxes that the Union government shares with the States.

Statement III: Proceeds from cess are directly credited to the Public Account of India rather than Consolidated Fund of India.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I
b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I
c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I
d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.1) किसी देश की, कर-से-जीडीपी अनुपात में कमी क्या सूचित करती है?
1. आर्थिक वृद्धि दर धीमी होना
2. राष्ट्रीय आय का कम समान (एक्विटेबल) वितरण
नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग कर सही उत्तर चुनिए।
a) केवल 1
b) केवल 2
c) 1 और 2 दोनों
d) न तो 1 और न ही 2

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.2) एक यात्रा वेबसाइट होटल के कमरों का किराया ₹2,000 प्रति रात बताकर विज्ञापन करती है। किंतु बुकिंग प्रक्रिया के दौरान कर, इंटरनेट उपयोग शुल्क और अन्य सुविधाओं के शुल्क जोड़ दिए जाते हैं, जिससे कुल कीमत ₹2,750 हो जाती है। यह स्थिति उपभोक्ताओं को अंतिम कीमत के बारे में भ्रमित करती है और सूचित निर्णय लेने की उनकी क्षमता को सीमित कर देती है।
यह निम्नलिखित में से किस व्यवहार का वर्णन है?
a) बेट एंड स्विच
b) प्राइस गाउजिंग
c) ड्रिप प्राइसिंग
d) बास्केट स्नीकिंग

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.3) भारत में विभिन्न वित्तीय संस्थानों के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित जानकारी पर विचार कीजिए:

संस्था का नाम	**स्थापना**	**मंत्रालय के अंतर्गत कार्य**
I. आर्थिक आसूचना परिषद (EIC)	सरकार के कार्यकारी आदेश द्वारा	वित्त मंत्रालय
II. वित्तीय आसूचना इकाई – भारत (FIU-IND)	सरकार के कार्यकारी आदेश द्वारा	गृह मंत्रालय
III. गंभीर धोखाधड़ी जांच कार्यालय (SFIO)	संसद द्वारा बनाए गए कानून के अंतर्गत	कॉरपोरेट कार्य मंत्रालय

उपर्युक्त में से कितनी पंक्तियों में दी गई जानकारी सही सुमेलित है?
a) केवल एक
b) केवल दो
c) सभी तीन
d) कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.4) किसी कर प्रणाली को 'प्रगतिशील कर संरचना' तब कहा जाता है जब कर की आय लोच होती है:
a) 1 के बराबर
b) 0 और 1 के बीच
c) 1 से अधिक
d) 0 के बराबर

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.5) भारत में उपकर (cess) के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
कथन I: संघ के कर राजस्व में उपकरों का जितना अधिक हिस्सा होगा, राज्यों को संघ द्वारा वितरित किए जाने वाले कर राजस्व की मात्रा उतनी कम होगी।
कथन II: उपकर को उन करों के विभाज्य पूल से बाहर रखा जाता है जिन्हें संघ सरकार राज्यों के साथ साझा करती है।
कथन III: उपकर से प्राप्त आय सीधे भारत के सार्वजनिक खाते में जमा की जाती है, न कि भारत की संचित निधि में।
उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा सही है?
a) कथन II और कथन III दोनों सही हैं और दोनों ही कथन I की व्याख्या करते हैं
b) कथन II और कथन III दोनों सही हैं, परंतु उनमें से केवल एक कथन I की व्याख्या करता है
c) कथन II और कथन III में से केवल एक सही है और वही कथन I की व्याख्या करता है
d) न तो कथन II सही है और न ही कथन III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.6) Consider the following taxes:
I. Angel Tax
II. Wealth Tax
III. Equalization Levy
IV. Dividend Distribution Tax
V. Fringe Benefit Tax
How many of the above taxes presently have been abolished by the Government of India?
a) Only two
b) Only three
c) Only four
d) All the five

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.7) With reference to the Capital Gains Tax in India, consider the following statements:
I. Capital gains arising from the transfer of Virtual Digital Assets such as cryptocurrencies and Non-Fungible Tokens (NFTs) are taxed at a flat rate of 30% irrespective of the period of holding.
II. An equity share listed in a recognised stock exchange in India will be considered as a short term capital asset for the purpose of capital gains tax if the period of holding is less than 18 months.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.8) With reference to inflation trends in India between the FY 2022-23 and FY 2024-25, consider the following statements:
I. The average annual retail inflation, as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI) has steadily decreased during the period.
II. During this period, the average annual Wholesale Price Index (Headline) inflation rate has never recorded negative values.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.9) Consider the following statements about the Tax Collected at Source (TCS) in India:
I. Under it, a person (deductor) who is liable to make payment of specified nature to any other person (deductee) shall deduct tax at source and remit the same into the account of the government
II. The provisions relating to TCS are laid down under the Income-tax Act, 1961.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.10) With reference to the White Winged Duck, consider the following statements:
I. It usually inhabits the open grassland ecosystems and is rarely found in dense forests.
II. It is a crepuscular bird as it is most active at dusk and dawn.
III. It is listed as 'Endangered' under the IUCN Red List of Threatened Species.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) II only
b) II and III
c) I and II
d) I and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.6) निम्नलिखित करों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. एंजेल टैक्स
II. संपत्ति कर
III. समकारी लेवी
IV. लाभांश वितरण कर
V. फ्रिंज बेनिफिट टैक्स
उपर्युक्त में से वर्तमान में भारत सरकार द्वारा कितने कर समाप्त कर दिए गए हैं?
a) केवल दो
b) केवल तीन
c) केवल चार
d) सभी पाँच

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.7) भारत में पूंजीगत लाभ कर के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. क्रिप्टोकरेंसी और अपूरणीय टोकन (NFTs) जैसे आभासी डिजिटल परिसंपत्तियों (VDAs) के हस्तांतरण से प्राप्त पूंजीगत लाभ पर धारण अवधि की परवाह किए बिना 30% की स्थिर दर से कर लगाया जाता है।
II. भारत के किसी मान्यता प्राप्त स्टॉक एक्सचेंज में सूचीबद्ध इक्विटी शेयर को पूंजीगत लाभ कर के उद्देश्य से अल्पकालिक पूंजीगत संपत्ति माना जाएगा यदि धारण अवधि 18 महीने से कम हो।
उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?
a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.8) वित्तीय वर्ष 2022-23 से वित्तीय वर्ष 2024-25 के बीच भारत में मुद्रास्फीति प्रवृत्तियों के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. उपभोक्ता मूल्य सूचकांक (CPI) द्वारा मापी गई औसत वार्षिक खुदरा मुद्रास्फीति इस अवधि के दौरान लगातार घटती रही है।
II. इस अवधि के दौरान औसत वार्षिक थोक मूल्य सूचकांक (WPI) मुद्रास्फीति दर ने कभी भी नकारात्मक मान दर्ज नहीं किया।
उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?
a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.9) भारत में टैक्स कलेक्टेड एट सोर्स (TCS) के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. इसके अंतर्गत वह व्यक्ति (कटौतीकर्ता) जो किसी अन्य व्यक्ति (प्राप्तकर्ता) को निर्दिष्ट प्रकृति का भुगतान करने के लिए उत्तरदायी है, स्रोत पर कर की कटौती करता है और उसे सरकार के खाते में जमा करता है।
II. TCS से संबंधित प्रावधान आयकर अधिनियम, 1961 के अंतर्गत निर्धारित किए गए हैं।
उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?
a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.10) व्हाइट-विंग्ड डक के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. यह सामान्यतः खुले घास भूमि पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र में निवास करती है और घने वनों में बहुत कम पाई जाती है।
II. यह एक क्रिपस्कुलर पक्षी है, अर्थात यह सांझ और भोर के समय सबसे अधिक सक्रिय रहती है।
III. इसे IUCN रेड लिस्ट में संकटग्रस्त श्रेणी में सूचीबद्ध किया गया है।
उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?
a) केवल II
b) II और III
c) I और II
d) I और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.11) Which of the following statements are correct?

1. Ability to pay the principle of taxation holds that the amount of taxes people pay should relate to their income or wealth
2. The Benefit Principle of taxation states that individuals should be taxed in proportion to the benefit they receive from government programmes.
3. A progressive tax takes a larger share of tax from poor families than it does from rich families.
4. Indirect taxes have the advantage of being cheaper and easier to collect.

Select the correct answer using the-codes given below

a) 1 and 3 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1, 2 and 4 only
d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.12) In the context of Indian economy, consider the following statements about Consumer Price Index-Combined (CPI) and the Wholesale Price Index (WPI):

I. The base year for the current series of the WPI is 2011-12, while the base year for the CPI is 2024.
II. CPI includes the price changes of both goods and services whereas WPI only includes the price changes of services.
III. WPI is compiled by Office of the Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce & Industry, while CPI is compiled by National Statistical Office (NSO), Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)

Which of the statements given above are correct?

a) I and II only
b) I and III only
c) II and III only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.13) In the context of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) regime in India, what is the primary distinction between zero-rated supplies and exempted supplies?

a) Exempted supplies primarily include exports, whereas zero-rated supplies include essential goods such as fresh vegetables.
b) A registered person supplying exempted goods is required to issue a tax invoice, whereas zero-rated supplies require the issuance of a bill of supply.
c) Input Tax Credit (ITC) can be claimed for zero-rated supplies, whereas it cannot be claimed for exempted supplies.
d) Input supplies used for making exempted supplies are tax-free, whereas input supplies used for making zero-rated supplies are taxed.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.14) With reference to Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM), consider the following statements:

I. It is a statutory body.
II. The Chairman of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM) is an ex-officio member of the Financial Stability and Development Council.
III. It can examine and analyse macroeconomic issues affecting the Indian economy suo motu.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) III only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.11) निम्नलिखित कथनों में से कौन से सही हैं ?

1. कर देय क्षमता सिद्धांत यह मानता है कि लोग करों की जिस राशि का भुगतान करते हैं, हैं, वह उनके आय या संपत्ति के सापेक्ष होनी चाहिए
2. कराधान का हित लाभ सिद्धांत यह बताता है कि व्यक्तियों पर कर, सरकारी कार्यक्रमों से उन्हें मिलने वाले हित-लाभ के अनुपात में लगाया जाना चाहिए
3. प्रगतिशील कर धनी परिवारों से कर का जितना भाग लेता है, निर्धन परिवारों से उसकी अपेक्षा अधिक भाग प्राप्त करता है
4. अप्रत्यक्ष करों का लाभ यह है कि वे अपेक्षाकृत सस्ते होते हैं और आसानी से एकत्र किये जाते हैं

नीचे दिये गये कूट का प्रयोग कर सही उत्तर चुनिए :

a) केवल 1 और 3
b) केवल 2 और 3
c) केवल 1, 2 और 4
d) 1, 2, 3 और 4

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.12) भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था के संदर्भ में उपभोक्ता मूल्य सूचकांक-समेकित (CPI) और थोक मूल्य सूचकांक (WPI) के बारे में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. WPI की वर्तमान श्रृंखला का आधार वर्ष 2011–12 है, जबकि CPI का आधार वर्ष 2024 है।
II. CPI में वस्तुओं और सेवाओं दोनों की कीमतों में परिवर्तन शामिल होते हैं, जबकि WPI केवल सेवाओं की कीमतों में परिवर्तन को शामिल करता है।
III. WPI को वाणिज्य और उद्योग मंत्रालय के अंतर्गत आर्थिक सलाहकार कार्यालय द्वारा संकलित किया जाता है, जबकि CPI को राष्ट्रीय सांख्यिकी कार्यालय (NSO), सांख्यिकी और कार्यक्रम कार्यान्वयन मंत्रालय (MoSPI) द्वारा संकलित किया जाता है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-से सही हैं?

a) केवल I और II
b) केवल I और III
c) केवल II और III
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.13) भारत में वस्तु एवं सेवा कर (GST) व्यवस्था के संदर्भ में शून्य-दर आपूर्ति और मुक्त आपूर्ति के बीच मुख्य अंतर क्या है?

a) मुक्त आपूर्ति मुख्यतः निर्यात को शामिल करती है, जबकि शून्य-दर आपूर्ति में ताजी सब्जियों जैसे आवश्यक वस्तुएँ शामिल होती हैं।
b) मुक्त वस्तुओं की आपूर्ति करने वाले पंजीकृत व्यक्ति को कर चालान (Tax Invoice) जारी करना आवश्यक होता है, जबकि शून्य-दर आपूर्ति के लिए आपूर्ति बिल (Bill of Supply) जारी किया जाता है।
c) शून्य-दर आपूर्ति के लिए इनपुट टैक्स क्रेडिट (ITC) का दावा किया जा सकता है, जबकि मुक्त आपूर्ति के लिए ITC का दावा नहीं किया जा सकता।
d) मुक्त आपूर्ति के लिए उपयोग की जाने वाली आगत आपूर्तियाँ कर-मुक्त होती हैं, जबकि शून्य-दर आपूर्ति के लिए उपयोग की जाने वाली आगत आपूर्तियों पर कर लगाया जाता है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.14) प्रधानमंत्री की आर्थिक सलाहकार परिषद (EAC-PM) के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह एक वैधानिक निकाय है।
II. प्रधानमंत्री की आर्थिक सलाहकार परिषद (EAC-PM) के अध्यक्ष वित्तीय स्थिरता और विकास परिषद (FSDC) के पदेन सदस्य होते हैं।
III. यह भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था को प्रभावित करने वाले व्यापक आर्थिक मुद्दों का स्वतः (Suo Motu) परीक्षण और विश्लेषण कर सकती है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I और II
b) केवल II और III
c) केवल III
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.15) With reference to the Ramsar Sites in India, consider the following pairs:

Ramsar Site	Located In
I. Sakkarakottai Bird Sanctuary	Karnataka
II. Therthangal Bird Sanctuary	Tamil Nadu
III. Khecheopalri Wetland	Assam
IV. Udhwa Lake Bird Sanctuary	Jharkhand

How many of the above given pairs are correctly matched?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) Only three
d) All the four

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.16) With reference to the presumptive taxation scheme in India, consider the following statements:
I. Presumptive taxation is permitted under the Income Tax Act, 1961.
II. Under presumptive taxation, eligible taxpayers may declare income at a prescribed percentage of their turnover without maintaining detailed books of account.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.17) The Liptako-Gourma region, often mentioned in the news for security challenges, is a tri-border area involving which three countries?
a) Senegal, Mauritania, and Mali
b) Mali, Burkina Faso, and Niger
c) Chad, Sudan, and Eritrea
d) Nigeria, Chad, and Niger

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.18) Regarding the recently concluded 6th BIMSTEC Summit, consider the following statements:
I. The 6th BIMSTEC Summit was held in Bangkok, Thailand under the theme "BIMSTEC: Prosperous, Resilient, and Open,"
II. India is set to host the first-ever BIMSTEC Games in 2027.
III. The group's headquarters is located in Bangkok, Thailand.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) I and III only
d) I, II, and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.19) With reference to the Tropical Forest Forever Facility (TFFF), consider the following statements:
I. It proposes the creation of a $125 billion investment fund to incentivise protection of tropical forests.
II. India is among the proponents of the Tropical Forest Forever Facility.
III. The facility aims to reward countries for maintaining standing tropical forests through financial returns generated from investments.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) I and III only
d) I, II, and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.20) Recently, which of the following organizations has replaced the United India Insurance Company as the fund manager of the Environment Relief Fund (ERF)?
a) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development
b) National Biodiversity Authority
c) Oriental Insurance Company Limited
d) Central Pollution Control Board

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.15) भारत में रामसर स्थलों के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित युग्मों पर विचार कीजिए:

रामसर स्थल	स्थित राज्य
I. सक्करकोट्टई पक्षी अभयारण्य	कर्नाटक
II. थेरथंगल पक्षी अभयारण्य	तमिलनाडु
III. खेचोपलरी आर्द्रभूमि	असम
IV. उधवा झील पक्षी अभयारण्य	झारखंड

उपर्युक्त में से कितने युग्म सही सुमेलित हैं?

a) केवल एक
b) केवल दो
c) केवल तीन
d) सभी चार

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.16) भारत में अनुमानित कराधान योजना के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. अनुमानित कराधान की अनुमति आयकर अधिनियम, 1961 के अंतर्गत दी गई है।
II. अनुमानित कराधान योजना के अंतर्गत पात्र करदाता बिना विस्तृत लेखा-पुस्तकें बनाए, अपने कारोबार के टर्नओवर के एक निर्धारित प्रतिशत के आधार पर आय घोषित कर सकते हैं।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.17) लिप्टाको-गौरमा क्षेत्र, जिसका उल्लेख अक्सर सुरक्षा चुनौतियों के लिए समाचारों में किया जाता है, एक त्रि-सीमा क्षेत्र है जिसमें निम्नलिखित में से कौन से तीन देश शामिल हैं?

a) सेनेगल, मॉरिटानिया और माली
b) माली, बुर्किना फासो और नाइजर
c) चाड, सूडान और इरिट्रिया
d) नाइजीरिया, चाड और नाइजर

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.18) हाल ही में संपन्न हुए छठे बिम्सटेक (BIMSTEC) शिखर सम्मेलन के संबंध में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. छठा बिम्सटेक शिखर सम्मेलन बैंकॉक, थाईलैंड में "बिम्सटेक: समृद्ध, लचीला और खुला" थीम के तहत आयोजित किया गया था।
II. भारत 2027 में पहले बिम्सटेक खेलों की मेजबानी करने के लिए तैयार है।
III. समूह का मुख्यालय बैंकॉक, थाईलैंड में स्थित है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन से सही हैं?

a) केवल I और II
b) केवल II और III
c) केवल I और III
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.19) ट्रॉपिकल फॉरेस्ट फॉरएवर फैसिलिटी (TFFF) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह उष्णकटिबंधीय वनों के संरक्षण को प्रोत्साहित करने के लिए 125 अरब डॉलर के निवेश कोष के निर्माण का प्रस्ताव करता है।
II. भारत उष्णकटिबंधीय वन स्थायी सुविधा के प्रस्तावकों में से एक है।
III. यह सुविधा निवेश से उत्पन्न वित्तीय प्रतिफल के माध्यम से खड़े उष्णकटिबंधीय वनों को बनाए रखने के लिए देशों को पुरस्कृत करने का लक्ष्य रखती है।

उपर्युक्त में से कौन से कथन सही हैं?

a) केवल I और II
b) केवल II और III
c) केवल I और III
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.20) हाल ही में निम्नलिखित में से किस संगठन ने पर्यावरण राहत कोष (ERF) के फंड प्रबंधक के रूप में यूनाइटेड इंडिया इंश्योरेंस कंपनी का स्थान लिया है?

a) राष्ट्रीय कृषि और ग्रामीण विकास बैंक
b) राष्ट्रीय जैव विविधता प्राधिकरण
c) ओरिएंटल इंश्योरेंस कंपनी लिमिटेड
d) केंद्रीय प्रदूषण नियंत्रण बोर्ड

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.21) Under which of the following circumstances may 'capital gains' arise?

1. when there is an increase in the sales of a product.
2. when there is a natural increase in the value of the property owned.
3. when you purchase a painting and there is a growth in its value due to increase in its popularity.

Select the correct answer using the codes given below:

a) 1 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 2 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.22) With reference to the Industrial Policy Resolution, 1956, consider the following statements:

I. It is regarded as the 'Economic Constitution of India'.
II. It introduced a three way classification of industries.
III. It allowed the establishment of fully owned foreign companies only in highly export oriented sectors or sophisticated technology areas.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I and III only
b) I and II only
c) II only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.23) With reference to economic planning in India, consider the following statements:

Statement I: The Union Government adopted rolling plans following the Fifth Five Year Plan.

Statement II: The Kothari Commission recommended a rolling plan for better targeting of unemployment and poverty levels.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.24) Consider the following statements:

Statement I: An inverted duty structure can lead to cash flow shortages and liquidity issues for manufacturers.

Statement II: Under an inverted duty structure, the tax rate on inputs is higher than the tax rate on finished goods, resulting in the accumulation of unutilized Input Tax Credit (ITC).

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.25) The "MISHTI" initiative of the Government of India is primarily aimed at:

a) regeneration and restoration of coral reefs.
b) production of biofuel using agricultural wastes.
c) restoration and conservation of mangrove ecosystems.
d) reduction of greenhouse gas emissions.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.21) निम्नलिखित में से किन परिस्थितियों में पूंजीगत लाभ उत्पन्न हो सकता है?

1. जब किसी उत्पाद की बिक्री में वृद्धि होती है।
2. जब स्वामित्व वाली संपत्ति के मूल्य में प्राकृतिक वृद्धि होती है।
3. जब आप एक पेंटिंग खरीदते हैं और उसकी लोकप्रियता बढ़ने के कारण उसके मूल्य में वृद्धि हो जाती है।

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए:

a) केवल 1
b) केवल 2 और 3
c) केवल 2
d) 1, 2 और 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.22) औद्योगिक नीति संकल्प, 1956 के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. इसे भारत का 'आर्थिक संविधान' माना जाता है।
II. इसने उद्योगों का तीन-स्तरीय वर्गीकरण प्रस्तुत किया है।
III. इसने पूर्ण स्वामित्व वाली विदेशी कंपनियों की स्थापना को केवल अत्यधिक निर्यात-उन्मुख क्षेत्रों या उन्नत प्रौद्योगिकी क्षेत्रों में अनुमति दी।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I और III
b) केवल I और II
c) केवल II
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.23) भारत में आर्थिक नियोजन के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

कथन I: पाँचवीं पंचवर्षीय योजना के बाद केंद्र सरकार ने रोलिंग योजना को अपनाया।

कथन II: कोठारी आयोग ने बेरोजगारी और गरीबी के स्तर को बेहतर तरीके से लक्षित करने के लिए रोलिंग योजना की सिफारिश की थी।

उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा सही है?

a) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं और कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या करता है
b) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं और कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या नहीं करता है
c) कथन I सही है लेकिन कथन II सही नहीं है
d) कथन I सही नहीं है लेकिन कथन II सही है

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.24) निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

कथन I: व्युत्क्रम कर संरचना के कारण निर्माताओं को नकदी प्रवाह की कमी और तरलता संबंधी समस्याएं हो सकती हैं।

कथन II: व्युत्क्रम कर संरचना की स्थिति तब उत्पन्न होती है जब आगत पर कर की दर तैयार माल पर कर की दर से अधिक होती है, जिससे अप्रयुक्त आगत कर जमा (इनपुट टैक्स क्रेडिट-ITC) का संचय हो जाता है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा सही है?

a) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं और कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या करता है
b) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं लेकिन कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या नहीं करता है
c) कथन I सही है लेकिन कथन II सही नहीं है
d) कथन I सही नहीं है लेकिन कथन II सही है

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.25) भारत सरकार की "मिष्टी (MISHTI)" पहल मुख्य रूप से किस उद्देश्य के लिए शुरू की गई है?

a) प्रवाल भित्तियों के पुनर्जीवन और पुनर्स्थापन के लिए।
b) कृषि अपशिष्टों का उपयोग करके जैव ईंधन उत्पादन के लिए।
c) मैंग्रोव पारिस्थितिकी तंत्र के संरक्षण और पुनर्स्थापन के लिए।
d) ग्रीनहाउस गैस उत्सर्जन में कमी लाने के लिए।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.26) Consider the following initiatives:
I. Atal Innovation Mission
II. Aspirational District Programme/ Aspirational Block Programme
III. Bharat Startup Knowledge Access Registry (BHASKAR)
IV. Women Entrepreneurship Platform
Which of the above are initiatives of the National Institution for Transforming India (NITI Aayog)?
a) I and II only
b) III and IV only
c) I, II and IV only
d) I, II, III and IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.27) Consider the following statements:
The Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council shall make recommendations to the Union and States on:
I. the standard GST rates applicable on specific goods and services.
II. the goods and services that may be subjected to, or exempted from GST.
III. the threshold limit of turnover below which goods and services may be exempt from GST.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) I and III only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.28) In the context of inflation, the momentum effect reflects/captures the:
a) the impact of price levels from the previous year's base period on the current year-on-year inflation calculation.
b) the inflationary pressure caused by an increase in the speed at which money circulates in the economy.
c) the sudden spikes in food and fuel prices driven specifically by supply-side shocks.
d) month-on-month price changes in the current year.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.29) In the context of an economy, the term 'biflation' refers to the simultaneous occurrence of:
a) Inflation and unemployment.
b) Demand-pull inflation and cost-push inflation.
c) Rising prices of goods and services in both domestic and global markets.
d) Inflation and deflation.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.30) With reference to the Wetland City Accreditation (WCA), recently seen in news, consider the following statements:
I. This Accreditation is provided under the World Heritage Convention of United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO).
II. Vadnagar and Jaipur have become the first two Indian cities to achieve the Wetland City Accreditation.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.31) Which of the following statements is/are true with respect to Phillips Curve?
1. It shows the trade-off between unemployment and inflation.
2. The downward sloping curve of Phillips curve is generally held to be valid only in the short run.
3. In the long run, Phillips Curve is usually thought to be horizontal at the Non-Accelerating Inflation Rate of Unemployment (NAIRU).
Select the correct answer using the codes given below
a) 2 and 3 only
b) Only 1
c) 1 and 2 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.26) निम्नलिखित पहलों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. अटल नवाचार मिशन
II. आकांक्षी जिला कार्यक्रम/आकांक्षी ब्लॉक कार्यक्रम
III. भारत स्टार्टअप नॉलेज एक्सेस रजिस्ट्री (BHASKAR)
IV. महिला उद्यमिता मंच
उपर्युक्त में से कौन सी पहल नेशनल इंस्टीट्यूशन फॉर ट्रांसफॉर्मिंग इंडिया (नीति आयोग) की हैं?
a) केवल I और II
b) केवल III और IV
c) केवल I, II और IV
d) I, II, III और IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.27) निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
वस्तु एवं सेवा कर (GST) परिषद केंद्र और राज्यों को निम्नलिखित विषयों पर अनुशंसाएँ देगी:
I. विशिष्ट वस्तुओं और सेवाओं पर लागू मानक GST दरें।
II. वे वस्तुएं और सेवाएं जिन पर GST लागू हो सकता है या जिन्हें GST से छूट दी जा सकती है।
III. कारोबार की वह सीमा जिसके नीचे वस्तुओं और सेवाओं को GST से छूट दी जा सकती है।
उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन से सही हैं?
a) केवल I और II
b) केवल II और III
c) केवल I और III
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.28) मुद्रास्फीति के संदर्भ में, संवेग प्रभाव (momentum effect) किसे दर्शाता है?
a) वर्तमान वर्ष-दर-वर्ष मुद्रास्फीति गणना पर पिछले वर्ष की आधार अवधि के मूल्य स्तरों का प्रभाव।
b) अर्थव्यवस्था में मुद्रा के संचलन की गति में वृद्धि के कारण होने वाला मुद्रास्फीति का दबाव।
c) विशेष रूप से आपूर्ति-पक्ष के व्यवधानों के कारण खाद्य और ईंधन की कीमतों में अचानक उछाल।
d) वर्तमान वर्ष में महीने-दर-महीने होने वाले मूल्य परिवर्तन।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.29) अर्थव्यवस्था के संदर्भ में, 'द्विस्फीति (Biflation)' शब्द निम्नलिखित के एक साथ घटित होने को संदर्भित करता है:
a) मुद्रास्फीति और बेरोजगारी।
b) मांग-प्रेरित मुद्रास्फीति और लागत-प्रेरित मुद्रास्फीति।
c) घरेलू और वैश्विक दोनों बाजारों में वस्तुओं और सेवाओं की बढ़ती कीमतें।
d) मुद्रास्फीति और अपस्फीति।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.30) हाल ही में खबरों में आई वेटलैंड सिटी प्रमाणन (WCA) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:
I. यह मान्यता संयुक्त राष्ट्र शैक्षिक, वैज्ञानिक और सांस्कृतिक संगठन (यूनेस्को) के विश्व धरोहर सम्मेलन के अंतर्गत प्रदान की जाती है।
II. बड़नगर और जयपुर वेटलैंड सिटी प्रमाणन प्राप्त करने वाले पहले दो भारतीय शहर बन गए हैं।
उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन सा/से सही है/हैं?
a) केवल I
b) केवल II
c) I और II दोनों
d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.31) फिलिप्स वक्र के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा/से कथन सत्य है/हैं?
1. यह बेरोजगारी और मुद्रास्फीति के बीच ट्रेड-ऑफ को दर्शाता है।
2. फिलिप्स वक्र का नीचे की ओर ढलान वाला वक्र सामान्यतः केवल अल्पकाल में ही मान्य माना जाता है।
3. दीर्घकाल में, फिलिप्स वक्र को आमतौर पर बेरोजगारी की गैर-त्वरित मुद्रास्फीति दर (NAIRU) पर क्षैतिज माना जाता है।
नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए:
a) केवल 2 और 3
b) केवल 1
c) केवल 1 और 2
d) 1, 2 और 3

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.32) Consider the following statements in respect of NITI Aayog and erstwhile Planning Commission:

I. Unlike NITI Aayog , the Planning Commission was a statutory body.

II. Unlike the Planning commission, the Union Ministers can be members of NITI Aayog.

III. Unlike the Planning commission, NITI Aayog does not have the power to allocate funds to ministries and state governments.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I and II only
b) III only
c) II and III only
d) None of the Above

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.33) The Wage Rate Index (WRI) in India is compiled and maintained by:

a) National Statistical Office (NSO)
b) Labour Bureau
c) NITI Aayog
d) Reserve Bank of India

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.34) With reference to the Indian economy, cost-push inflation can be caused/increased by which of the following?

I. Rise in global oil prices
II. Decreasing interest rates in the economy.
III. Increase in wages
IV. Increase in the government spending

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) I and III only
b) II and IV only
c) I, III and IV
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.35) Which one of the following correctly describes the "Wallace Line"?

a) A geographical boundary that marks significant climatic variation between the tropics and temperate regions.
b) A geographical boundary that marks the distinct difference in the distribution of flora and fauna between the regions of Asia and Australia.
c) A marine region characterized by high coral reef diversity separating the Indian and Pacific oceans.
d) A tectonic boundary separating the Eurasian and Australian continental plates.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.36) Consider the following statements:

Statement I: Lenders/Creditors are generally negatively impacted by inflation.

Statement II: Inflation erodes the purchasing power of money over time.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct, but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct, but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct, but Statement-II is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.37) In the context of public finance, a Pigouvian tax primarily refers to a tax imposed to:

a) Encourage the consumption of merit goods by lowering their effective prices.
b) Discourage activities that generate negative externalities.
c) Redistribute income from high-income to low-income groups.
d) Provide fiscal incentives to promote exports of manufactured goods.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.32) नीति आयोग और पूर्ववर्ती योजना आयोग के संबंध में निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. नीति आयोग के विपरीत, योजना आयोग एक वैधानिक निकाय था।

II. योजना आयोग के विपरीत, केंद्रीय मंत्री नीति आयोग के सदस्य हो सकते हैं।

III. योजना आयोग के विपरीत, नीति आयोग के पास मंत्रालयों और राज्य सरकारों को निधि आवंटित करने का अधिकार नहीं है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I और II

b) केवल III

c) केवल II और III

d) उपर्युक्त में से कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.33) भारत में मजदूरी दर सूचकांक (WRI) का संकलन और रखरखाव किसके द्वारा किया जाता है?

a) राष्ट्रीय सांख्यिकी कार्यालय (NSO)

b) श्रम ब्यूरो

c) नीति आयोग

d) भारतीय रिजर्व बैंक

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.34) भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित में से कौन से कारक लागत-प्रेरित मुद्रास्फीति का कारण बन सकते हैं/बढ़ा सकते हैं?

I. वैश्विक तेल कीमतों में वृद्धि

II. अर्थव्यवस्था में घटती ब्याज दरें

III. मजदूरी में वृद्धि

IV. सरकारी खर्च में वृद्धि

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए:

a) केवल I और III

b) केवल II और IV

c) I, III और IV

d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.35) निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा विकल्प "वॉलेस लाइन" का सही वर्णन करता है?

a) एक भौगोलिक सीमा जो उष्णकटिबंधीय और समशीतोष्ण क्षेत्रों के बीच महत्वपूर्ण जलवायु भिन्नता को दर्शाती है।

b) एक भौगोलिक सीमा जो एशिया और ऑस्ट्रेलिया के क्षेत्रों के बीच वनस्पतियों और जीवों के वितरण में स्पष्ट अंतर को दर्शाती है।

c) एक समुद्री क्षेत्र जो उच्च प्रवाल भित्ति विविधता से युक्त है और हिंद महासागर और प्रशांत महासागर को अलग करता है।

d) एक विवर्तनिक सीमा जो यूरेशियन और ऑस्ट्रेलियाई महाद्वीपीय प्लेटों को अलग करती है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.36) निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

कथन I: आम तौर पर मुद्रास्फीति से उधारदाताओं/ऋणदाताओं पर नकारात्मक प्रभाव पड़ता है।

कथन II: मुद्रास्फीति समय के साथ मुद्रा की क्रय शक्ति को कम कर देती है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा कथन सही है?

a) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं और कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या करता है।

b) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं, लेकिन कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या नहीं करता है।

c) कथन I सही है, लेकिन कथन II सही नहीं है।

d) कथन I सही नहीं है, लेकिन कथन II सही है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.37) सार्वजनिक वित्त के संदर्भ में, पिगूवियन कर मुख्य रूप से निम्नलिखित उद्देश्यों के लिए लगाए जाने वाले कर को संदर्भित करता है:

a) प्रभावी कीमतों को कम करके गुणपरक वस्तुओं (मेरिट गुड्स) के उपभोग को प्रोत्साहित करना।

b) नकारात्मक बाह्यता उत्पन्न करने वाली गतिविधियों को हतोत्साहित करना।

c) उच्च आय वर्ग से निम्न आय वर्ग में आय का पुनर्वितरण करना।

d) निर्मित वस्तुओं के निर्यात को बढ़ावा देने के लिए राजकोषीय प्रोत्साहन प्रदान करना।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.38) In the context of certain terms seen in the news, consider the following pairs:

Term	Description
I. Shrinkflation	A situation marked by rising prices in only a few sectors of the economy.
II. Stagflation	An economic situation marked by stagnant economic output and high price inflation.
III. Disinflation	An economic situation where there is a consistent decline in price level.
IV. Skewflation	It occurs when there is reduction in the quantity or size of a product but consumers still pay the earlier price.

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?

a) Only one
b) Only two
c) Only three
d) All the four

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.39) With reference to the Reverse Charge Mechanism (RCM) under the Goods and Services Tax (GST) in India, consider the following statements:

I. Under it, the liability to pay tax is on the recipient of supply of goods or services instead of the supplier of such goods or services in respect of notified categories of supply.
II. A person who is required to pay tax under the reverse charge has to register under GST only if the annual turnover is more than 40 lakhs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.40) With reference to the Commission on Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture (CGRFA), consider the following statements:

I. It is the only permanent intergovernmental body that addresses biological diversity for food and agriculture.
II. It operates under the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations.
III. It works to ensure fair and equitable sharing of benefits derived from the use of genetic resources.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

a) I and III only
b) I and II only
c) II and III only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.41) Core inflation is :

a) CPI headline inflation minus all non-food items
b) WPI inflation minus all food and non-food items
c) CPI headline inflation minus food and energy items
d) WPI inflation minus food and energy items

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.42) In the context of financial transactions in India, which one of the following taxes is levied on foreign currency conversion transactions?

a) Goods and Services Tax (GST)
b) Securities Transaction Tax (STT)
c) Commodities Transaction Tax (CTT)
d) Short Term Capital Gains Tax (STCG)

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.38) समाचारों में देखे जाने वाले कुछ शब्दों के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित युग्मों पर विचार कीजिए:

शब्द	विवरण
I. श्रिंकफ्लेशन	अर्थव्यवस्था के केवल कुछ क्षेत्रों में कीमतों में वृद्धि की स्थिति।
II. रुद्ध मुद्रास्फीति (स्टैगफ्लेशन)	स्थिर आर्थिक उत्पादन और उच्च मूल्य मुद्रास्फीति की स्थिति।
III. अवस्फीति	मूल्य स्तर में निरंतर गिरावट की आर्थिक स्थिति।
IV. स्क्यूफ्लेशन	यह तब होती है जब किसी उत्पाद की मात्रा या आकार में कमी होती है लेकिन उपभोक्ता पहले वाली कीमत ही चुकाते हैं।

उपर्युक्त में से कितने युग्म सही सुमेलित हैं?

a) केवल एक

b) केवल दो

c) केवल तीन

d) सभी चार

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.39) भारत में वस्तु एवं सेवा कर (GST) के अंतर्गत रिवर्स चार्ज मैकेनिज्म (RCM) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. इसके अंतर्गत, अधिसूचित श्रेणियों की आपूर्ति के संबंध में, कर भुगतान का दायित्व वस्तुओं या सेवाओं के आपूर्तिकर्ता के बजाय आपूर्ति प्राप्तकर्ता पर होता है।

II. रिवर्स चार्ज के अंतर्गत कर का भुगतान करने के लिए बाध्य व्यक्ति को GST के अंतर्गत तभी पंजीकरण कराना होता है जब उसका वार्षिक कारोबार 40 लाख रुपये से अधिक हो।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन सा/से सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.40) खाद्य एवं कृषि के लिए आनुवंशिक संसाधन आयोग (CGRFA) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए:

I. यह एकमात्र स्थायी अंतरसरकारी निकाय है जो खाद्य एवं कृषि के लिए जैविक विविधता से संबंधित कार्य करता है।

II. यह संयुक्त राष्ट्र के खाद्य एवं कृषि संगठन (FAO) के अधीन कार्य करता है।

III. यह आनुवंशिक संसाधनों के उपयोग से प्राप्त लाभों के निष्पक्ष और समान वितरण को सुनिश्चित करने के लिए कार्य करता है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन से सही हैं?

a) केवल I और III

b) केवल I और II

c) केवल II और III

d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.41) मूल मुद्रास्फीति (Core inflation)है :

a) CPI हेडलाइन मुद्रास्फीति से सभी खाद्येतर मदें घटाने पर

b) WPI मुद्रास्फीति से सभी खाद्य और खाद्येतर मदें घटाने पर

c) CPI हेडलाइन मुद्रास्फीति से खाद्य और ऊर्जा मदें घटाने पर

d) WPI मुद्रास्फीति से खाद्य और ऊर्जा मदें घटाने पर

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.42) भारत में वित्तीय लेन-देन के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा कर विदेशी मुद्रा रूपांतरण लेन-देन पर लगाया जाता है?

a) वस्तु एवं सेवा कर (GST)

b) प्रतिभूति लेनदेन कर (STT)

c) वस्तु लेनदेन कर (CTT)

d) अल्पकालिक पूंजीगत लाभ कर (STCG)

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.43) Consider the following statements:

Statement I: Unlike Ad valorem taxes, specific taxes automatically adjust to inflation.

Statement II: Specific taxes are levied on the goods and services on per unit basis, whereas ad valorem taxes are levied as a percentage of the value of the good or service.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.44) Which among the following Five Year plans was also referred to as Mahalanobis Plan?

a) First Five Year plan
b) Second Five Year Plan
c) Third Five Year Plan
d) Fourth Five Year Plan

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.45) The term 'TrailGuard AI System' is sometimes seen in the news in the context of

a) Providing navigational services in emergency
b) Provision of weather forecasting services
c) Improving the vision of railway loco pilots
d) Prevention of human-wildlife conflicts

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.46) Consider the following:

I. People's Plan by M.N. Roy
II. Sarvodaya Plan by Jaiprakash Narayan
III. Visvesvaraya Plan by M. Visvesvaraya

Arrange the above initiatives with respect to planning in pre Independent India in the chronological order:

a) I - II - III
b) II - I - III
c) II - III - I
d) III - I - II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.47) Which of the following steps are most likely to be taken by the Government of India/ Reserve Bank of India during deflationary conditions?

I. Decrease in Income tax rates and corporation tax rates
II. Increasing the interest rates of small saving schemes
III. Decreasing the repo rate
IV. Selling of government securities

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) I and III only
b) II and IV only
c) I, II and III only
d) I, II, III and IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.48) With reference to the Securities Transaction Tax (STT) in India, consider the following statements:

I. It is an example of direct tax.
II. It is levied on every purchase and sale of securities listed on a recognised stock exchange, irrespective of whether the transaction results in a profit or a loss.
III. The liability to collect and remit STT lies with the recognized intermediaries through which the transaction is executed.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) I and III only
d) I, II and III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.43) निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए :

कथन I: मूल्याधारित करों के विपरीत, विशिष्ट कर स्वतः ही मुद्रास्फीति के अनुसार समायोजित हो जाते हैं।

कथन II: विशिष्ट कर वस्तुओं और सेवाओं पर प्रति इकाई के आधार पर लगाए जाते हैं, जबकि मूल्याधारित कर वस्तु या सेवा के मूल्य के प्रतिशत के रूप में लगाए जाते हैं।

उपर्युक्त कथनों के संबंध में निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा सही है?

a) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं तथा कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या करता है
b) कथन I और कथन II दोनों सही हैं, लेकिन कथन II, कथन I की व्याख्या नहीं करता है
c) कथन I सही है, लेकिन कथन II सही नहीं है
d) कथन I सही नहीं है, लेकिन कथन II सही है

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.44) निम्नलिखित में से किस पंचवर्षीय योजना को महालनोबिस योजना भी कहा जाता था?

a) प्रथम पंचवर्षीय योजना
b) द्वितीय पंचवर्षीय योजना
c) तृतीय पंचवर्षीय योजना
d) चतुर्थ पंचवर्षीय योजना

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.45) 'ट्रेलगार्ड AI सिस्टम' शब्द कभी-कभी समाचारों में किस संदर्भ में देखा जाता है?

a) आपातकालीन स्थिति में नेविगेशन सेवाएं प्रदान करना
b) मौसम पूर्वानुमान सेवाएं प्रदान करना
c) रेलवे लोको पायलटों की दृष्टि में सुधार करना
d) मानव-वन्यजीव संघर्ष की रोकथाम

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.46) निम्नलिखित पर विचार कीजिए :

I. एम.एन. रॉय द्वारा जन योजना
II. जयप्रकाश नारायण द्वारा सर्वोदय योजना
III. एम. विश्वेश्वरैया द्वारा विश्वेश्वरैया योजना

स्वतंत्रता-पूर्व भारत में योजना से संबंधित उपर्युक्त पहलों को कालानुक्रमिक क्रम में व्यवस्थित कीजिए:

a) I - II - III
b) II - I - III
c) II - III - I
d) III - I - II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.47) निम्नलिखित में से कौन-से कदम अपस्फीति की परिस्थितियों में भारत सरकार/भारतीय रिजर्व बैंक द्वारा उठाए जाने की सबसे अधिक संभावना है?

I. आयकर दरों और निगम कर दरों में कमी
II. लघु बचत योजनाओं की ब्याज दरों में वृद्धि
III. रेपो दर में कमी
IV. सरकारी प्रतिभूतियों की बिक्री

नीचे दिए गए कूट का उपयोग करके सही उत्तर चुनिए:

a) केवल I और III
b) केवल II और IV
c) केवल I, II और III
d) I, II, III और IV

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.48) भारत में प्रतिभूति लेनदेन कर (STT) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए :

I. यह प्रत्यक्ष कर का एक उदाहरण है।
II. यह मान्यता प्राप्त स्टॉक एक्सचेंज पर सूचीबद्ध प्रतिभूतियों की प्रत्येक खरीद और बिक्री पर लगाया जाता है, चाहे उस लेन-देन से लाभ हो या हानि।
III. STT को एकत्रित करने और जमा करने की जिम्मेदारी उन मान्यता प्राप्त मध्यस्थों की होती है जिनके माध्यम से लेनदेन निष्पादित किया जाता है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-से सही हैं?

a) केवल I और II
b) केवल II और III
c) केवल I और III
d) I, II और III

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.49) With reference to the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT), consider the following statements:
I. It is a statutory body.
II. It notifies Cost Inflation Index (CII) annually.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.50) Under which of the following situations, one can say that the phenomena of 'Biodiversity Leak' has occurred?
a) When an ecosystem can no longer sustain a population without causing environmental degradation.
b) When biodiversity declines more quickly inside protected areas as compared to outside areas.
c) When conservation efforts in some nations lead to biodiversity loss in other nations.
d) When the focus rests primarily on the conservation of specific species rather than preserving the entire ecosystem.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Directions for the following 4 (four) items:
Read the following three passages and answer the items that follow the passages. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only

Passage - 1

India's entry into the Pax Silica alliance is a strategic effort to secure its technological future by aligning with a U.S.-led coalition focused on AI infrastructure and critical minerals. Although India currently lacks significant capacity in the extraction and processing of critical minerals, it holds considerable strengths elsewhere. It contributes nearly 20% of global chip design engineering talent and possesses substantial electronics assembly capabilities, both of which are critical for diversifying global technology supply chains. Through participation in this ecosystem, India will seek to secure access to raw materials and advanced manufacturing equipment. Membership in the alliance will also advance domestic industrial objectives by reinforcing initiatives such as India Semiconductor, India AI Mission, and the National Critical Minerals Mission. Together, these could strengthen India's position in AI and critical mineral value chains.

Q.51) Which one of the following statements best reflects the most logical and rational inference that can be drawn from the passage?
a) Contemporary geopolitics revolves around securing critical mineral supply chains.
b) India's entry into the Pax Silica alliance will give a major boost to India's domestic manufacturing sector.
c) While India is not a major producer of critical minerals, it can play a pivotal role in securing supply chains as a member of Pax Silica.
d) India needs to strengthen its domestic infrastructure for critical mineral extraction in order to benefit from its membership in the Pax Silica alliance.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.52) With reference to above passage, the following assumptions have been made:
I. India's entry into the Pax Silica alliance will transform it into a leader in critical mineral value chains by 2035.
II. India's technological talent base constitutes one of its core strategic assets.
Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.49) केंद्रीय प्रत्यक्ष कर बोर्ड (CBDT) के संदर्भ में, निम्नलिखित कथनों पर विचार कीजिए :

I. यह एक वैधानिक निकाय है।

II. यह प्रति वर्ष लागत मुद्रास्फीति सूचकांक (CII) अधिसूचित करता है।

उपर्युक्त कथनों में से कौन-से सही हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.50) निम्नलिखित में से किस स्थिति में यह कहा जा सकता है कि 'जैव विविधता रिसाव' (Biodiversity Leak) की घटना घटित हुई है?

a) जब कोई पारितंत्र पर्यावरणीय क्षरण उत्पन्न किए बिना किसी जनसंख्या को बनाए रखने में सक्षम नहीं रहता।

b) जब संरक्षित क्षेत्रों के भीतर जैव विविधता में गिरावट, बाहरी क्षेत्रों की तुलना में अधिक तेज़ी से होती है।

c) जब कुछ देशों में संरक्षण के प्रयास अन्य देशों में जैव विविधता की हानि का कारण बनते हैं।

d) जब ध्यान मुख्य रूप से संपूर्ण पारितंत्र को संरक्षित करने के बजाय विशिष्ट प्रजातियों के संरक्षण पर केंद्रित रहता है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

निम्नलिखित 4 (चार) प्रश्नांशों के लिए निर्देश:
निम्नलिखित तीन परिच्छेदों को पढ़िए और परिच्छेदों के बाद दिए गए प्रश्नों के उत्तर दीजिए। इन प्रश्नों के आपके उत्तर केवल परिच्छेदों पर आधारित होने चाहिए।

परिच्छेद - 1

पैक्स सिलिका गठबंधन में भारत का प्रवेश अपने तकनीकी भविष्य को सुरक्षित करने के लिए एक रणनीतिक प्रयास है, जिसमें वह कृत्रिम बुद्धिमत्ता अवसंरचना और महत्वपूर्ण खनिजों पर केंद्रित अमेरिका-नेतृत्व वाले गठबंधन के साथ जुड़ रहा है। यद्यपि वर्तमान में भारत के पास महत्वपूर्ण खनिजों के निष्कर्षण और प्रसंस्करण की पर्याप्त क्षमता नहीं है, फिर भी अन्य क्षेत्रों में उसकी उल्लेखनीय क्षमताएँ हैं। वैश्विक स्तर पर चिप डिज़ाइन इंजीनियरिंग प्रतिभा का लगभग 20% भारत से आता है और उसके पास इलेक्ट्रॉनिक्स असेंबली की पर्याप्त क्षमता भी है, जो वैश्विक प्रौद्योगिकी आपूर्ति श्रृंखलाओं के विविधीकरण के लिए अत्यंत महत्वपूर्ण है। इस पारितंत्र में भागीदारी के माध्यम से भारत कच्चे माल और उन्नत विनिर्माण उपकरणों तक पहुँच सुनिश्चित करने का प्रयास करेगा। इस गठबंधन की सदस्यता घरेलू औद्योगिक उद्देश्यों को भी आगे बढ़ाएगी, क्योंकि इससे इंडिया सेमीकंडक्टर, इंडिया एआई मिशन और राष्ट्रीय महत्वपूर्ण खनिज मिशन जैसी पहलों को सुदृढ़ता मिलेगी। ये सभी मिलकर एआई और महत्वपूर्ण खनिज मूल्य श्रृंखलाओं में भारत की स्थिति को मजबूत कर सकते हैं।

Q.51) निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा कथन उस परिच्छेद से निकाले जा सकने वाले सबसे तार्किक और युक्तिसंगत निष्कर्ष को सर्वोत्तम रूप से व्यक्त करता है?

a) समकालीन भू-राजनीति महत्वपूर्ण खनिज आपूर्ति श्रृंखलाओं को सुरक्षित करने के इर्द-गिर्द केंद्रित है।

b) पैक्स सिलिका गठबंधन में भारत का प्रवेश भारत के घरेलू विनिर्माण क्षेत्र को बड़ा प्रोत्साहन देगा।

c) यद्यपि भारत महत्वपूर्ण खनिजों का प्रमुख उत्पादक नहीं है, फिर भी वह पैक्स सिलिका का सदस्य होने के नाते आपूर्ति श्रृंखलाओं को सुरक्षित करने में एक महत्वपूर्ण भूमिका निभा सकता है।

d) पैक्स सिलिका गठबंधन की सदस्यता से लाभ प्राप्त करने के लिए भारत को महत्वपूर्ण खनिजों के निष्कर्षण हेतु अपने घरेलू अवसंरचना को सुदृढ़ करने की आवश्यकता है।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.52) उपर्युक्त परिच्छेद के संदर्भ में निम्नलिखित धारणाएँ बनाई गई हैं :

I. पैक्स सिलिका गठबंधन में भारत के प्रवेश से यह 2035 तक महत्वपूर्ण खनिज मूल्य श्रृंखलाओं में अग्रणी देश बन जाएगा।

II. भारत की तकनीकी प्रतिभा आधार उसकी प्रमुख रणनीतिक संपत्तियों में से एक है।

उपर्युक्त में से कौन-सी धारणा/धारणाएँ सही है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Passage - 2

The development and deployment of emerging technologies have long been approached with caution because of their dual-use nature i.e., their capacity to generate both beneficial and harmful applications. This characteristic creates a dilemma with significant policy implications, as efforts to advance innovation can simultaneously raise concerns about misuse. Such dynamics can heighten tensions and fuel competitive cycles among states. For example, the infrastructure, materials, tools, and expertise used to develop vaccines or conduct genomic surveillance during disease outbreaks can also be redirected for manufacturing biological weapons. As a result, distinguishing between activities intended to strengthen public health security and those that could be exploited by malicious actors is becoming increasingly difficult.

Q.53) Based on the above passage, the following assumptions have been made:

I. Governments should curb the development and use of dual-use technologies.

II. Policy makers need to ensure that dual-use technologies are utilized for the benefit of the public.

Which of the assumptions given above is/are valid?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Passage - 3

Every Indian student studying abroad represents a financial outflow of tuition fees, living expenses and long-term economic contributions. Host countries gain not only in revenue but also through greater campus diversity, stronger research capacity and workforce participation. International students also bring cultural and intellectual exchange that enriches academic ecosystems. India's failure to attract international students at scale means forfeiting these benefits while reinforcing its image as a source of talent rather than a destination for learning. India has two options. Either it continues to excel at exporting students while remaining largely invisible on the global education map, or it commits to building universities that attract learners from around the world. How it responds will shape not only its education system but also its place in the global knowledge economy for decades to come.

Q.54) Which one of the following statements best reflects the most rational, logical and practical message conveyed by the passage?

a) Greater campus diversity in educational institutions promotes intellectual dialogue.
b) When Indian students choose foreign destinations for higher education, the country suffers a loss of both human and economic capital.
c) India needs to improve its educational infrastructure to attract global talent and strengthen its knowledge-based economy.
d) India should position itself as a global hub for education in the coming decade.

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.55) What is the rightmost digit preceding the zeros in the value of 20^{20}?

a) 2
b) 4
c) 6
d) 8

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.56) The population of a colony of bacteria grows in Geometric Progression. On the third day, the population was recorded as exactly m, while on the 10th day it was found to be exactly 2m. If the population on the 9th day was n and that on the 100th day was kn, what is the value of k?

a) 8192
b) 2096
c) 3246
d) 5468

100%		75%		50%		0%	

परिच्छेद - 2

उभरती प्रौद्योगिकियों का विकास और उनका उपयोग लंबे समय से सावधानी के साथ किया जाता रहा है, क्योंकि उनकी द्वैध-उपयोग (dual-use) प्रकृति होती है—अर्थात वे लाभकारी और हानिकारक दोनों प्रकार के अनुप्रयोग उत्पन्न करने की क्षमता रखती हैं। यह विशेषता एक ऐसी दुविधा उत्पन्न करती है जिसके महत्वपूर्ण नीतिगत निहितार्थ होते हैं, क्योंकि नवाचार को आगे बढ़ाने के प्रयासों के साथ-साथ उनके दुरुपयोग को लेकर चिंताएँ भी बढ़ सकती हैं। ऐसी परिस्थितियाँ देशों के बीच तनाव को बढ़ा सकती हैं और प्रतिस्पर्धा की प्रवृत्ति को भी प्रोत्साहित कर सकती हैं। उदाहरण के लिए, रोग प्रकोप के दौरान टीकों के विकास या जीनोमिक निगरानी के लिए उपयोग किए जाने वाले अवसंरचना, सामग्री, उपकरण और विशेषज्ञता को जैविक हथियारों के निर्माण के लिए भी प्रयुक्त किया जा सकता है। परिणामस्वरूप, सार्वजनिक स्वास्थ्य सुरक्षा को सुदृढ़ करने के उद्देश्य से की जाने वाली गतिविधियों और दुष्ट तत्वों द्वारा दुरुपयोग की संभावनाओं के बीच अंतर करना दिन-प्रतिदिन अधिक कठिन होता जा रहा है।

Q.53) उपर्युक्त परिच्छेद के आधार पर निम्नलिखित धारणाएँ बनाई गई हैं :

I. सरकारों को द्वैध-उपयोग प्रौद्योगिकियों के विकास और उपयोग को सीमित कर देना चाहिए।

II. नीति-निर्माताओं को यह सुनिश्चित करना चाहिए कि द्वैध-उपयोग प्रौद्योगिकियों का उपयोग जनहित के लिए किया जाए।

उपर्युक्त में से कौन-सी धारणा/धारणाएँ मान्य है/हैं?

a) केवल I

b) केवल II

c) I और II दोनों

d) न तो I और न ही II

100%		75%		50%		0%	

परिच्छेद - 3

विदेश में अध्ययन करने वाला प्रत्येक भारतीय छात्र शुल्क, जीवन-यापन व्यय और दीर्घकालिक आर्थिक योगदान के रूप में वित्तीय बहिर्वाह का प्रतिनिधित्व करता है। मेजबान देशों को इससे केवल राजस्व ही नहीं मिलता, बल्कि अधिक परिसर विविधता, मजबूत शोध क्षमता और कार्यबल में भागीदारी के माध्यम से भी लाभ होता है। अंतरराष्ट्रीय छात्र सांस्कृतिक और बौद्धिक आदान-प्रदान भी लेकर आते हैं, जो शैक्षणिक पारितंत्र को समृद्ध करता है। बड़े पैमाने पर अंतरराष्ट्रीय छात्रों को आकर्षित करने में भारत की विफलता का अर्थ है कि वह इन लाभों से वंचित हो रहा है और साथ ही यह धारणा मजबूत हो रही है कि भारत सीखने का गंतव्य बनने के बजाय प्रतिभा का स्रोत मात्र है। भारत के सामने दो विकल्प हैं। या तो वह छात्रों को विदेश भेजने में उत्कृष्ट बना रहे और वैश्विक शिक्षा मानचित्र पर लगभग अदृश्य बना रहे, या फिर वह ऐसे विश्वविद्यालयों के निर्माण के लिए प्रतिबद्ध हो जो दुनिया भर से शिक्षार्थियों को आकर्षित करें। भारत की प्रतिक्रिया न केवल उसकी शिक्षा प्रणाली, बल्कि आने वाले दशकों में वैश्विक ज्ञान अर्थव्यवस्था में उसकी स्थिति को भी आकार देगी।

Q.54) निम्नलिखित में से कौन-सा कथन परिच्छेद द्वारा व्यक्त सबसे तर्कसंगत, तार्किक और व्यावहारिक संदेश को सर्वोत्तम रूप से प्रतिबिंबित करता है?

a) शैक्षणिक संस्थानों में अधिक परिसर विविधता बौद्धिक संवाद को प्रोत्साहित करती है।

b) जब भारतीय छात्र उच्च शिक्षा के लिए विदेशी गंतव्यों को चुनते हैं, तो देश को मानव और आर्थिक पूंजी दोनों की हानि होती है।

c) वैश्विक प्रतिभा को आकर्षित करने और अपनी ज्ञान-आधारित अर्थव्यवस्था को मजबूत करने के लिए भारत को अपने शैक्षणिक अवसंरचना में सुधार करने की आवश्यकता है।

d) भारत को आने वाले दशक में स्वयं को शिक्षा के एक वैश्विक केंद्र के रूप में स्थापित करना चाहिए।

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.55) 20^{20} के मान में अंत में आने वाले शून्यों से पहले का सबसे दायाँ अंक क्या है?

a) 2

b) 4

c) 6

d) 8

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.56) एक कॉलोनी में बैक्टीरिया की जनसंख्या गुणोत्तर श्रेणी (जियोमेट्रिक प्रोग्रेशन) में बढ़ती है। तीसरे दिन जनसंख्या m दर्ज की गई, जबकि दसवें दिन यह 2m पाई गई। यदि 9वें दिन जनसंख्या n थी और 100वें दिन kn थी, तो k का मान क्या है?

a) 8192

b) 2096

c) 3246

d) 5468

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.57) What is the largest number which divides both $2^{35} - 1$ and $2^{91} - 1$?
a) 34
b) 90
c) 127
d) 129

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.58) What is the difference between simple interest and compound interest on Rs.10,000 for two years at 20% per annum compounded half-yearly?
a) Rs.842
b) Rs.756
c) Rs.641
d) Rs.542

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.59) The average age of the three sisters is 17 years. If the age of their brother is included, the average age of all four persons remains an odd number. What is the minimum possible age of the brother, given that his age is not less than 2 years?
a) 3 years
b) 5 years
c) 9 years
d) 13 years

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.60) A family of two generations consisting of six members P, Q, R, S, T and U has three males and three females. There are two married couples and two unmarried siblings. U is P's daughter and Q is R's mother-in-law. T is an unmarried male and S is a male. Which one of the following is correct?
a) R is U's husband.
b) R is S's wife.
c) S is unmarried.
d) None of the above

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.57) वह सबसे बड़ी संख्या क्या है जो $2^{35} - 1$ और $2^{91} - 1$ दोनों को विभाजित करती है?

a) 34

b) 90

c) 127

d) 129

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.58) ₹10,000 पर दो वर्षों के लिए 20% वार्षिक दर से चक्रवृद्धि ब्याज (अर्धवार्षिक रूप से संयोजित) और साधारण ब्याज के बीच क्या अंतर है?

a) ₹842

b) ₹756

c) ₹641

d) ₹542

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.59) तीन बहनों की औसत आयु 17 वर्ष है। यदि उनके भाई की आयु शामिल कर ली जाए, तो सभी चार व्यक्तियों की औसत आयु एक विषम संख्या रहती है। भाई की न्यूनतम संभावित आयु क्या है, बशर्ते कि उसकी आयु 2 वर्ष से कम न हो?

a) 3 वर्ष

b) 5 वर्ष

c) 9 वर्ष

d) 13 वर्ष

100%		75%		50%		0%	

Q.60) दो पीढ़ियों वाले एक परिवार में छह सदस्य P, Q, R, S, T और U हैं, जिसमें तीन पुरुष और तीन महिलाएं हैं। यहाँ दो विवाहित जोड़े और दो अविवाहित सहोदर (भाई-बहन) हैं। U, P की पुत्री है और Q, R की सास है। T एक अविवाहित पुरुष है और S एक पुरुष है। निम्नलिखित में से कौन सा सही है?

a) R, U का पति है।

b) R, S की पत्नी है।

c) S अविवाहित है।

d) उपर्युक्त में से कोई नहीं

100%		75%		50%		0%	

SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK

Q.1) A decrease in tax to GDP ratio of a country indicates which of the following?
1. Slowing economic growth rate.
2. Less equitable distribution of national income.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below.
a) 1 only
b) 2 only
c) Both 1 and 2
d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer:
Statement 1 is correct but Statement 2 is incorrect. Tax to GDP ratio compares the amount of taxes collected by a government to the amount of income that country receives for its products. A decrease in tax to GDP ratio of a country indicates a slowing economic growth. When tax revenues grow at a slower rate than the GDP of a country, the tax-to GDP ratio drops.
Source: UPSC CSE Pre 2015
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.2) A travel website advertises hotel rooms at ₹2,000 per night. However, during the booking process, additional charges for taxes, internet access and amenities are revealed, raising the total price to ₹2,750. This practice misleads consumers about the final cost and limits informed decision-making. This is the description of which of the following practices?
a) Bait and switch
b) Price gouging
c) Drip pricing
d) Basket sneaking

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Option a is incorrect: A **bait-and-switch** is a fraudulent sales practice where a seller advertises an appealing, low-priced product (the "bait") to **lure customers,** only to claim it is unavailable **and pressure them into purchasing a more expensive or inferior item (the "switch").**
Option b is incorrect: Price gouging is the practice of raising prices for essential goods and services (like water, food, fuel, or medicine) **to unfairly high levels,** usually during a state of emergency, natural disaster, or crisis. It exploits sudden demand spikes as sellers maximize profits when consumers have few options.
Option c is correct: Under the Guidelines for Prevention and Regulation of Dark Patterns, 2023, 'Drip Pricing' is a dark pattern which misleads consumers about the final payable amount and undermines informed decision-making. Drip pricing is **a strategy where only a portion of an item's cost is initially displayed, with the full amount revealed later during the purchase process.**

- The price advertised, whether in print, email, or on a website (referred to as the “headline price”), may not accurately reflect the final cost to the consumer.

Such practice also **contravenes** Rule 7(1)(e) of **the Consumer Protection (E-Commerce) Rules, 2020,** which requires the total price, inclusive of all charges and taxes, to be displayed upfront.
Option d is incorrect: Basket sneaking is a deceptive e-commerce "dark pattern" where **additional products, services, or charity donations are added to a user's shopping cart** without their explicit consent during checkout. This tactic increases the final bill amount, often by pre-selecting items or using hidden checkboxes to manipulate users into paying.
Source:) https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/industry/services/retail/firstcry-faces-rs-2-lakh-penalty-for-misleading-ads-and-unfair-trade-practices/articleshow/124159099.cms?from=mdr

https://www.hindustantimes.com/business/centre-issues-warning-against-drip-pricing-what-is-it-101714907056107.html
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2146813&reg=3&lang=2
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Inflation
Subtopic:)

Q.3) With reference to various financial Institutions in India, consider the following information:

Name of the Institution	Established	Works under
I. Economic Intelligence Council (EIC)	by Executive Order of the Government	Ministry of Finance
II. Financial Intelligence Unit - India (FIU-IND)	by Executive Order of the Government	Ministry of Home Affairs
III. Serious Fraud Investigation Office (SFIO)	under a Law enacted by Parliament	Ministry of Corporate Affairs

In how many of the above rows is the given information correctly matched?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) All the three
d) None

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
Row I is correct: Economic Intelligence Council (EIC) is an apex body set up for mitigation of Economic Offences by Multi-Agency coordination on the recommendation of the Group of Ministers. **It is an executive body (created by an executive resolution) and chaired by the Finance Minister, Govt. of India.** Central Economic Intelligence Bureau serves as Secretariat and Director General, CEIB acts as Member Secretary of EIC.
Economic Intelligence Council (EIC) is tasked with developing strategies for the collection, collation, and dissemination of intelligence related to economic security while ensuring its effective utilization by relevant agencies. It reviews measures to combat economic offences, formulates coordinated strategies for enforcement, and strengthens the functioning of intelligence and enforcement agencies under the Ministry of Finance. Through its mandate, the EIC fosters inter-agency coordination and dynamic responses to evolving economic threats.
Row II is incorrect: Financial Intelligence Unit – India (FIU-IND) was set by the Government of India via resolution (non-statutory body) as the central national agency responsible for receiving, processing, analyzing and disseminating information relating to suspect financial transactions. FIU-IND is also responsible for coordinating and strengthening efforts of national and international intelligence, investigation and enforcement agencies in pursuing the global efforts against money laundering and financing of terrorism. **FIU-IND is an independent body reporting directly to the Economic Intelligence Council (EIC) headed by the Finance Minister.**
Row III is correct: Serious Fraud Investigation Office (SFIO) **is a statutory body notified under the Companies Act, 2013. It is a multi-disciplinary organization under the Ministry of Corporate Affairs,** of experts in the field of accountancy, forensic auditing, law, information technology, investigation, company law, capital market, banking and taxation, etc., for detecting and prosecuting or recommending for prosecution of crimes/frauds.
Source: https://ceib.gov.in/economic-intelligence-council-eic
https://egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/68782/1/Block-3.pdf
https://dor.gov.in/financial-intelligence-unit-india-fiu-ind
https://sfio.gov.in/en/about-sfio-history/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.4) A tax system is characterized as a 'Progressive Tax Structure' when the income elasticity of tax is:
a) Equal to 1
b) Between 0 and 1
c) Greater than 1
d) Equal to 0

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
In public finance, economists often analyse the **nature of a tax system** by examining how **tax revenue changes with changes in income**. This relationship is captured through the concept of **income elasticity of tax**.
Income elasticity of tax measures the **percentage change in tax revenue resulting from a one percent change in income**. In simple terms, it shows **how quickly the tax burden rises as income increases**.
A tax system is considered **progressive** when **tax payments increase faster than income**. This means that **higher-income individuals contribute a larger share of their income as tax compared to lower-income individuals**. This situation arises when the **income elasticity of tax is greater than one**. For example, if income rises by **10%** but tax revenue rises by **15%**, the tax system is progressive.
Source: https://egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/60509/3/Unit-11.pdf - Unit 11 - Direct Taxes - Ability to Pay Approach - Equal Absolute Sacrifice – Page 33
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.5) Consider the following statements regarding Cess in India:
Statement I: The greater the share of tax revenue of the Union from cesses, the lower will be the tax revenues distributed to the states by the Union.
Statement II: Cess is excluded from the purview of the divisible pool of taxes that the Union government shares with the States.
Statement III: Proceeds from cess are directly credited to the Public Account of India rather than Consolidated Fund of India.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
a) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct and both of them explain Statement I
b) Both Statement II and Statement III are correct but only one of them explains Statement I
c) Only one of the Statements II and III is correct and that explains Statement I
d) Neither Statement II nor Statement III is correct

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statements I and II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I. A **cess** is a form of tax levied by the Union government for a **specific and designated purpose**, such as education, health, or infrastructure development. As per Article 270 of the Constitution cess will be excluded from the purview of the divisible pool of taxes that the Union government must share with the States.
The greater the share of revenue of the Union from cesses, the lower the tax revenues distributed to States because cesses are not part of the divisible pool of taxes under Article 270 of the Indian Constitution.
Statement III is incorrect. Cess proceeds are **not directly credited to the Public Account of India**. Under **Article 266** of the Constitution, all revenues received by the Government of India, including cess are first credited to the Consolidated Fund of India. Subsequently, the proceeds may be transferred to specific funds created for the purpose for which the cess was levied.
Source: https://www.thehindu.com/business/Economy/the-hindu-explains-where-are-the-funds-collected-through-cess-parked/article61702083.ece#:~:text=The%20story%20so%20far:%20The,%2C%20surcharges%2C%20fees%20and%2

0cess. ; https://fincomindia.nic.in/asset/doc/commission-reports/15th-FC/reports/studies/Cesses%20and%20Surcharges.pdf – Page 9
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.6) Consider the following taxes:
I. Angel Tax
II. Wealth Tax
III. Equalization Levy
IV. Dividend Distribution Tax
V. Fringe Benefit Tax
How many of the above taxes presently have been abolished by the Government of India?
a) Only two
b) Only three
c) Only four
d) All the five

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Option I is correct: Angel Tax was imposed under the **Income Tax Act, 1961.** It taxed the **excess amount received by unlisted companies** (especially **start-ups**) when shares were issued at a price higher than their fair market value. The **government abolished Angel Tax in the Union Budget 2024–25** to promote investment in start-ups and improve the startup ecosystem in India.
Option II is correct: Wealth Tax was **levied on the net wealth of individuals, Hindu Undivided Families (HUFs), and companies above a specified threshold**. Due to its low revenue collection and high administrative cost, **it was abolished in the Union Budget 2015–16** and replaced with an additional surcharge on high-income individuals.
Option III is correct: Equalization Levy was **introduced in 2016 to tax digital transactions involving non-resident digital companies operating in India without a physical presence.** Initially, it applied to **online advertising services at a rate of 6%. Later,** a 2% levy on e-commerce operators was introduced in 2020**.** The government subsequently abolished the 2% levy on e-commerce operators with effect from August 1, 2024, and removed the remaining **Equalization Levy on online advertising from April 1, 2025, in order to streamline digital taxation and align with evolving international tax frameworks.**
Option IV is correct: Earlier, **companies were required to pay Dividend Distribution Tax (DDT) before distributing dividends to shareholders**. The **Finance Act, 2020 abolished DDT,** and dividends are now taxed directly in the hands of shareholders according to their applicable income tax slab.
Option V is correct: Fringe Benefit Tax (FBT) was introduced in 2005 to **tax certain perquisites and benefits provided by employers to employees**, such as entertainment expenses, employee welfare, and travel benefits. Due to criticism from industry and the complexity of compliance, the tax was **abolished in the Union Budget 2009.**
Source:)
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleaseIframePage.aspx?PRID=2035599
https://www.thehindu.com/business/govt-proposes-to-abolish-equalisation-levy-on-online-advertisements/article69370428.ece
Indian Economy by Ramesh Singh, Chapter: 17 – Tax Structure in India, Page: 491.
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

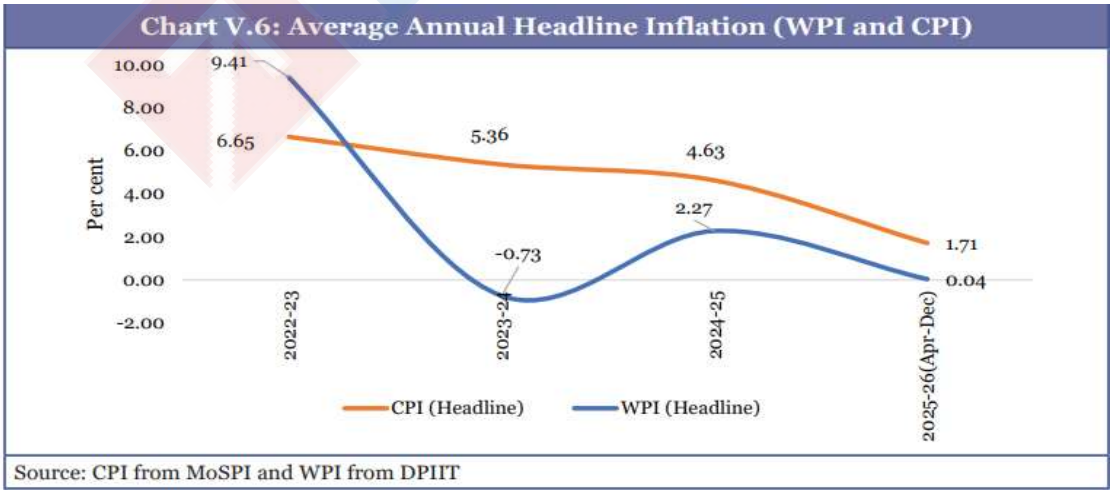
Q.7) With reference to the Capital Gains Tax in India, consider the following statements:
I. Capital gains arising from the transfer of Virtual Digital Assets such as cryptocurrencies and Non-Fungible Tokens (NFTs) are taxed at a flat rate of 30% irrespective of the period of holding.

II. An equity share listed in a recognised stock exchange in India will be considered as a short term capital asset for the purpose of capital gains tax if the period of holding is less than 18 months.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Statement I is correct: Under the taxation framework introduced through the **Finance Act, 2022**, a special provision was inserted in the **Income-tax Act, 1961** to tax income arising from the transfer of **Virtual Digital Assets** (VDAs) such as **cryptocurrencies** and **Non-Fungible Tokens** (NFTs**). Such gains are taxed at a flat rate of 30%, irrespective of the holding period of the asset**. Unlike most other capital assets, the distinction between short-term and long-term does not affect the tax rate for VDAs.
Statement II is incorrect: **For listed equity shares and equity-oriented mutual funds**, a **holding period of more than 12 months qualifies them as long-term capital assets.** If they are held for 12 months or less, the gains are treated as short-term capital gains.
Source:) https://incometaxindia.gov.in/Pages/faqs.aspx?k=FAQs+on+Capital+Gains
Indian Economy by Forum IAS, Chapter: 10 - Taxation, Page: 152.
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.8) With reference to inflation trends in India between the FY 2022-23 and FY 2024-25, consider the following statements:
I. The average annual retail inflation, as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI) has steadily decreased during the period.
II. During this period, the average annual Wholesale Price Index (Headline) inflation rate has never recorded negative values.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.



Statement I is correct: Over the past four years, average retail inflation, as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI), has followed a clear downward trajectory, declining steadily from 6.7 per cent in the financial year (FY) 2022–23 to 1.7 per cent in 2025–26 (till December)

Since FY 2022-23, **India's annual CPI inflation has shown a steadily declining trend.** It followed a clear downward trajectory, **declining steadily from 6.7 per cent in FY 2022–23 to 4.63 per cent in 2024–25.**

Statement II is incorrect: During this period, **WPI inflation did record negative values**, indicating phases of wholesale price deflation. For instance, the value of **WPI inflation was -0.73 per cent in FY 2023–24**.

Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap05.pdf Page: 208.

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Economic Survey 2025-26

Subtopic:)

Q.9) Consider the following statements about the Tax Collected at Source (TCS) in India:

I. Under it, a person (deductor) who is liable to make payment of specified nature to any other person (deductee) shall deduct tax at source and remit the same into the account of the government

II. The provisions relating to TCS are laid down under the Income-tax Act, 1961.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only

b) II only

c) Both I and II

d) Neither I nor II

Ans) b

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement I is incorrect: The **statement describes** the mechanism of **Tax Deducted at Source** (TDS) **rather than Tax Collected at Source** (TCS).

- The concept of TDS was introduced with an aim to collect tax from the very source of income. **As per this concept, a person (deductor) who is liable to make payment of specified nature to any other person (deductee) shall deduct tax at source and remit the same into the account of the Government.**
- The **deducted amount** is then **deposited** with the **Central Government on behalf of** the **recipient,** and the recipient receives credit for that tax while filing the income tax return.

In contrast, **TCS operates differently:**

- Under this system, the **seller of certain specified goods or the specified person collects tax from the buyer at the time of sale or at the time of receipt of payment**.
- The **collected tax** is then **deposited with the government**.

Thus, **in TDS** the **tax is deducted by the payer**, whereas in **TCS** the **tax is collected by the seller from the buyer.**

Statement II is correct: The provisions for Tax Collected at Source (TCS) are primarily governed by **Section 206C** of the **Income-tax Act, 1961.**

Source:)

https://incometaxindia.gov.in/Pages/Deposit_TDS_TCS.aspx

https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/wealth/tax/what-are-tds-tcs-and-what-is-the-difference-between-them/articleshow/122116265.cms?from=mdr

https://www.thehindu.com/business/all-you-need-to-know-about-new-tds-norms-from-july-1/article34925669.ece

https://www.thehindubusinessline.com/portfolio/personal-finance/what-is-tax-collection-at-source-tcs-heres-a-primer/article32800985.ece

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Taxation

Subtopic:)

Q.10) With reference to the White Winged Duck, consider the following statements:
I. It usually inhabits the open grassland ecosystems and is rarely found in dense forests.
II. It is a crepuscular bird as it is most active at dusk and dawn.
III. It is listed as 'Endangered' under the IUCN Red List of Threatened Species.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) II only
b) II and III
c) I and II
d) I and III

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Statement I is incorrect. White-winged duck is a large, rare, and endangered species of duck **found in freshwater wetlands and dense tropical forests of South and Southeast Asia.** It prefers dense tropical and subtropical forests with slow-moving rivers, swamps, and wetlands.
The states of Assam and Arunachal Pradesh alone harbour about 50% of its global population. It was once distributed widely across north-east India and south-east Asia. But now, only about 800 survive in the wild of which about 450 are present in India, Bangladesh and Myanmar. In India, the duck is limited to Assam and Arunachal Pradesh.
Statement II is correct. It is a crepuscular bird as it is most active at dusk and dawn.
Statement III is incorrect. It is listed as **Critically Endangered** in IUCN Red List.
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025), Page: 66
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Q.11) Which of the following statements are correct?
1. Ability to pay the principle of taxation holds that the amount of taxes people pay should relate to their income or wealth
2. The Benefit Principle of taxation states that individuals should be taxed in proportion to the benefit they receive from government programmes.
3. A progressive tax takes a larger share of tax from poor families than it does from rich families.
4. Indirect taxes have the advantage of being cheaper and easier to collect.
Select the correct answer using the-codes given below
a) 1 and 3 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 1, 2 and 4 only
d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement 1 is correct- Ability to pay principle of taxation holds that the amount of taxes people pay should relate to their income or wealth.
Statement 2 is correct- The Benefit Principle of taxation states that individuals should be taxed in proportion to the benefit they receive from government programs.
Statement 3 is incorrect- A progressive tax takes a larger share of tax from rich families than it does from poor families.
Statement 4 is correct- Indirect taxes have the advantage of being cheaper and easier to collect.
Source: UPSC CDS [I] 2016
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.12) In the context of Indian economy, consider the following statements about Consumer Price Index-Combined (CPI) and the Wholesale Price Index (WPI):
I. The base year for the current series of the WPI is 2011-12, while the base year for the CPI is 2024.
II. CPI includes the price changes of both goods and services whereas WPI only includes the price changes of services.
III. WPI is compiled by Office of the Economic Adviser, Ministry of Commerce & Industry, while CPI is compiled by National Statistical Office (NSO), Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI)
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) I and III only
c) II and III only
d) I, II and III

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
Inflation refers to a sustained increase in the general price level of goods and services in an economy over time.
Inflation in India is mainly measured through two important price indices, the **Consumer Price Index (CPI)** and the **Wholesale Price Index (WPI)**.
Statement I is correct. The **WPI continues to use 2011–12 as its base year effective from 2017**, while the **CPI base year has been updated to 2024 (2024=100)** to improve the accuracy and representativeness of inflation measurement based on the latest consumption survey.
Statement II is incorrect. The **CPI measures retail prices paid by consumers**, which include both **goods and services** such as food, housing, education, and transport. In contrast, the **WPI tracks prices at the wholesale level** and mainly covers **goods such as primary articles, fuel, and manufactured products**, excluding services.
Statement III is correct. Wholesale Price Index (WPI): It is compiled by the Office of the Economic Adviser (OEA), which falls under the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry.
Consumer Price Index (CPI): It is compiled by the National Statistical Office (NSO), which is under the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI).
Source:) https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2227012&reg=3&lang=1
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2228577&reg=3&lang=1
https://forumias.com/blog/eco-103-inflation/
https://eaindustry.nic.in/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Inflation
Subtopic:)

Q.13) In the context of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) regime in India, what is the primary distinction between zero-rated supplies and exempted supplies?
a) Exempted supplies primarily include exports, whereas zero-rated supplies include essential goods such as fresh vegetables.
b) A registered person supplying exempted goods is required to issue a tax invoice, whereas zero-rated supplies require the issuance of a bill of supply.
c) Input Tax Credit (ITC) can be claimed for zero-rated supplies, whereas it cannot be claimed for exempted supplies.
d) Input supplies used for making exempted supplies are tax-free, whereas input supplies used for making zero-rated supplies are taxed.

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Option c is correct: Under the GST framework in India, **the primary distinction between zero-rated supplies and exempted supplies lies in the treatment of Input Tax Credit (ITC).**
Zero-rated supplies:

- **Zero-rated supplies** include **exports of goods or services** and **supplies made to Special Economic Zone** (SEZ) units or developers.
- These supplies are effectively **taxed at 0%,** but they are **not treated as exempt**.
- The **supplier is allowed to claim ITC on inputs and input services** used in making such supplies.
- Moreover, if the ITC cannot be utilized domestically, the supplier may claim a refund of the unutilized ITC.

Exempted supplies:

- Exempted supplies, on the other hand, refer **to goods or services that do not attract GST** either because they are specifically exempted or because they are subject to a nil rate of tax (for example, **many basic agricultural products** such as fresh fruits and vegetables).
- In such cases, although no GST is charged on the output supply, the **supplier cannot claim ITC on inputs** used in producing these supplies, and any such credit must be reversed.

Option a is incorrect: Exports of goods and services are **treated as zero-rated supplies** under the GST regime, whereas many **essential items** such as fresh vegetables are generally **classified as exempt supplies.**

Option b is incorrect: In the case of **exempted supplies**, a **registered person** is required to **issue a bill of supply instead of a tax invoice**. In contrast, **zero-rated supplies** such as exports are **issued with a normal tax invoice**.

Option d is incorrect: For **exempted supplies**, while the outward supply is not taxed, the **inputs used in making such supplies are still taxed** and ITC cannot be availed. In contrast, for **zero-rated supplies**, there is **no tax on the outward supplies** and **Input supplies are also** to be **tax free**.

Source:) https://gstcouncil.gov.in/sites/default/files/e-version-gst-flyers/Zero%20ratings%20of%20suplies.pdf
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.14) With reference to Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM), consider the following statements:
I. It is a statutory body.
II. The Chairman of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister (EAC-PM) is an ex-officio member of the Financial Stability and Development Council.
III. It can examine and analyse macroeconomic issues affecting the Indian economy suo motu.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) III only
d) I, II and III

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement I is incorrect: The Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister is a **non-constitutional, non-statutory advisory body attached to the Prime Minister's Office (PMO)** that provides advice on economic and related issues to the Government of India, particularly to the Prime Minister.
Statement II is incorrect: The Financial Stability and Development Council (FSDC) functions under the Ministry of Finance. FSDC is an autonomous body chaired by the Union Finance Minister.
The Chairman of the Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister is not an ex-officio member of FSDC.
Statement III is correct: The Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister has the mandate to examine and analyze macroeconomic issues affecting the Indian economy. According to its Terms of Reference, the **council may analyze matters** referred to it by the Prime Minister of India and provide policy advice, **as well as take up issues of macroeconomic importance on a suo motu basis.** It may also undertake any additional tasks assigned by the Prime Minister from time to time.
Source: https://eacpm.gov.in/about-us/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Planning

Subtopic:)

Q.15) With reference to the Ramsar Sites in India, consider the following pairs:

Ramsar Site	Located In
I. Sakkarakottai Bird Sanctuary	Karnataka
II. Therthangal Bird Sanctuary	Tamil Nadu
III. Khecheopalri Wetland	Assam
IV. Udhwa Lake Bird Sanctuary	Jharkhand

How many of the above given pairs are correctly matched?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) Only three
d) All the four

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
The Union Government has recently announced the addition of four new Ramsar sites in India, increasing the total to 89. The newly designated Ramsar sites include Sakkarakottai Bird Sanctuary and Therthangal Bird Sanctuary in Tamil Nadu, Khecheopalri Wetland in Sikkim, and Udhwa Lake in Jharkhand
Pair I is incorrect. Sakkarakottai Bird Sanctuary is in Tamil Nadu. It is situated near the Gulf of Mannar, along the Central Asian Flyway. The Sakkarakottai Tank was constructed in 1321 A.D. through Kudimaramattu (community participation). It supports species such as the Painted Stork, Black-headed Ibis, and others
Pair II is correct. Therthangal Bird Sanctuary is in Tamil Nadu. It is found near the Gulf of Mannar on the Central Asian Flyway. It is home to birds like the Painted Stork, Black-headed Ibis, and Spot-billed Pelican. It is known for its Babul (Acacia nilotica) trees.
Pair III is incorrect. Khecheopalri Wetland is in Sikkim. It is the first Ramsar site in Sikkim. Also referred to as the Wishing Lake, as it is believed to grant wishes. Locally, it is called Sho Dzo Sho, meaning "Oh Lady, Sit Here."It is a cirque type wetland that holds sacred significance for both Buddhists and Hindus.
Pair IV is correct. Udhwa Lake Bird Sanctuary is the first ever Ramsar site from the state of Jharkhand. The Site comprises two interconnected wetlands, Pataura Lake and Barhel Lake, which are surrounded by the hillocks of the Rajamahal Hills and linked by a channel to the Ganga River. In 2016, the Site was designated as an Important Bird and Biodiversity Area due to its role in providing habitat for over 140 birds. The Site provides habitat for the endangered band-tailed fish eagle (Haliaeetus leucoryphus) and the vulnerable common pochard (Aythya ferina) and lesser adjutant stork (Leptoptilos javanicus).
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Q.16) With reference to the presumptive taxation scheme in India, consider the following statements:
I. Presumptive taxation is permitted under the Income Tax Act, 1961.
II. Under presumptive taxation, eligible taxpayers may declare income at a prescribed percentage of their turnover without maintaining detailed books of account.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement I is correct: According to Sections 44AA of the Income Tax Act (1961), a person engaged in business or profession needs to maintain regular books of accounts under certain circumstances as per specific conditions. To relieve small taxpayers from such compliance burden, the **Income Tax Act** has **framed the presumptive taxation scheme** u/s 44AD, 44ADA and 44AE. A person adopting the presumptive taxation scheme can declare income at a prescribed rate.

Statement II is correct: Under the presumptive taxation scheme, **eligible taxpayers may declare income at a prescribed percentage of their turnover or gross receipts**. For example, under Section 44AD, small businesses may declare income as a prescribed percentage of turnover instead of computing actual profits. In such cases, **taxpayers are not required to maintain detailed books of account**, which reduces compliance burden and simplifies tax filing for small businesses and professionals.

Source:)
https://www.incometax.gov.in/iec/foportal/help/e-filing-itr4-form-sugam-faq (Q.8)
https://www.thehindu.com/business/niti-aayog-pitches-for-presumptive-taxation-scheme-for-foreign-investors/article70121870.ece#google_vignette
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.17) The Liptako-Gourma region, often mentioned in the news for security challenges, is a tri-border area involving which three countries?
a) Senegal, Mauritania, and Mali
b) Mali, Burkina Faso, and Niger
c) Chad, Sudan, and Eritrea
d) Nigeria, Chad, and Niger

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
The Liptako-Gourma region is a geographical area in West Africa where the borders of Mali, Burkina Faso, and Niger meet. It has become one of the most troubled regions in the Sahel due to the presence of various armed groups and cross-border security threats.
Source:
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/mali-niger-burkina-sign-mutual-defence-pact/article67318978.ece
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Liptako-Gourma Region
Subtopic:)

Q.18) Regarding the recently concluded 6th BIMSTEC Summit, consider the following statements:
I. The 6th BIMSTEC Summit was held in Bangkok, Thailand under the theme "BIMSTEC: Prosperous, Resilient, and Open,"
II. India is set to host the first-ever BIMSTEC Games in 2027.
III. The group's headquarters is located in Bangkok, Thailand.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) I and III only
d) I, II, and III

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Statements I and II are correct: The 6th BIMSTEC Summit was held in Bangkok, Thailand under the theme "BIMSTEC: Prosperous, Resilient, and Open,"

India is set to host the first-ever BIMSTEC Games in 2027.

Statement III is incorrect: BIMSTEC Secretariat is located in Dhaka, Bangladesh, not Bangkok. The group was originally formed via the Bangkok Declaration, but the HQ is in Dhaka.

Source: https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2118698
https://www.thehindu.com/opinion/editorial/a-regional-revival-on-the-bimstec-summit/article69427340.ece
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Sixth BIMSTEC Summit
Subtopic:)

Q.19) With reference to the Tropical Forest Forever Facility (TFFF), consider the following statements:
I. It proposes the creation of a $125 billion investment fund to incentivise protection of tropical forests.
II. India is among the proponents of the Tropical Forest Forever Facility.
III. The facility aims to reward countries for maintaining standing tropical forests through financial returns generated from investments.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) I and III only
d) I, II, and III

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement I is Correct: The proposal involves a large investment fund (~$125 billion) to incentivise tropical forest conservation.
Statement II is Incorrect: India is currently only an observer, not a proponent.
Statement III is Correct: The mechanism plans to use returns from an investment fund to reward forest conservation.
Source:
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/india-joins-brazil-led-forest-fund-as-observer-calls-for-stronger-ambition-10-years-after-paris-pact/article70255373.ece
https://tfff.earth/
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Tropical Forest Forever Facility (TFFF)
Subtopic:)

Q.20) Recently, which of the following organizations has replaced the United India Insurance Company as the fund manager of the Environment Relief Fund (ERF)?
a) National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development
b) National Biodiversity Authority
c) Oriental Insurance Company Limited
d) Central Pollution Control Board

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
The Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change (MoEF&CC) has issued a notification amending the Environment Relief Fund (ERF) Scheme, 2008.
Important changes are as follows:

- The Environment Relief Fund (ERF) is now vested in the Central Government.
- **The Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB) replaced United India Insurance Company Ltd. as the fund manager for five years**, effective January 1, 2025.
- The fund manager will develop and maintain an online portal for fund disbursement, in consultation with the Central Government.
- ERF funds will be invested in public financial institutions and savings accounts to ensure timely availability.

- ERF funds will be allocated for restoring environmental damage caused by hazardous substances, including their manufacture, processing, storage, transportation, and disposal.

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025), Page: 52
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Q.21) Under which of the following circumstances may 'capital gains' arise?
1. when there is an increase in the sales of a product.
2. when there is a natural increase in the value of the property owned.
3. when you purchase a painting and there is a growth in its value due to increase in its popularity.
Select the correct answer using the codes given below:
a) 1 only
b) 2 and 3 only
c) 2 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer
Statements 2 and 3 are correct. Capital gain is an increase in a capital asset's value and is considered to be realized when the asset is sold. Realized capital gains and losses occur when an asset is sold, which triggers a taxable event. Unrealized gains and losses, sometimes referred to as paper gains and losses, reflect an increase or decrease in an investment's value but are not considered a capital gain that should be treated as a taxable event.
Source: UPSC CSE Pre 2012
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.22) With reference to the Industrial Policy Resolution, 1956, consider the following statements:
I. It is regarded as the 'Economic Constitution of India'.
II. It introduced a three way classification of industries.
III. It allowed the establishment of fully owned foreign companies only in highly export oriented sectors or sophisticated technology areas.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I and III only
b) I and II only
c) II only
d) I, II and III

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
The Government of India introduced the Industrial Policy of 1956 as a revision of its policy of 1948 to accelerate the rate of economic growth and the speeding up of industrialisation as a means of achieving a socialist pattern of society. It was **shaped by the Mahalanobis Model of growth** - involving investment in building a capacity in the production of capital goods or heavy industries leading to an economy with a long term higher growth path.
Statement I is correct: Industrial Policy Resolution (30 April, 1956) was also regarded as the "Economic Constitution of India". Major Objectives of Industrial Policy Resolution (1956) are as follows: improving living standards and working conditions for the mass of the people; to reduce disparities in income and wealth; to prevent private monopolies and concentration of economic power.
Statement I is correct: The Industrial Policy Resolution of 1956 classified industries into three categories:

- **Schedule A:** This schedule had **17 industrial areas in which the Centre was given complete monopoly.**

- **Schedule B:** There were 12 industrial areas put under this schedule i**n which the state governments were supposed to take up the initiatives with a more expansive follow up by the private sector.**
- **Schedule C:** All industrial areas left out of Schedules A and B were put under this **in which the private enterprises had the provisions to set up industries.**

Statement III is incorrect: The **Industrial Policy Statement, 1977 (and not the Industrial Policy Resolution, 1956)** stated that foreign companies that diluted their foreign equity up to 40 per cent under Foreign Exchange Regulation Act (FERA) 1973 were to be treated at par with the Indian companies. **Fully owned foreign companies were allowed only in highly export oriented sectors or sophisticated technology areas.** For all approved foreign investments, companies were completely free to repatriate capital and remit profits, dividends, royalties, etc.
Source:) https://egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/84867/3/Unit-14.pdf (Pg. 219 - 221)
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Planning
Subtopic:)

Q.23) With reference to economic planning in India, consider the following statements:
Statement I: The Union Government adopted rolling plans following the Fifth Five Year Plan.
Statement II: The Kothari Commission recommended a rolling plan for better targeting of unemployment and poverty levels.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement I is correct: Rolling Plan (1978 - 80) was adopted after the Fifth Five Year Plan (1974 - 79). After the **Janata Party government** came to power in **1977** under **Morarji Desai**, it terminated the Fifth Plan in 1978 and introduced the Rolling Plan for the period 1978–83. **The plan emphasised employment generation and sought to revise targets annually to maintain flexibility in planning.** However, the government lasted only until 1979. When the Indian National Congress returned to power in 1980 under Indira Gandhi, the Rolling Plan was abandoned and the Sixth Five Year Plan was launched with a focus on poverty alleviation and economic expansion.
Statement II is incorrect: The **adoption of Rolling Plans was not based on the recommendation of the Kothari Commission**. The commission, **established in 1964 under the chairmanship of Daulat Singh Kothari**, examined various aspects of the Indian **education system and made recommendations for educational reforms**. It had no role in recommending changes to India's economic planning framework.
Source:) https://www.mospi.gov.in/sites/default/files/Statistical_year_book_india_chapters/ch7.pdf (Pg. 3)
https://gtchooghly.ac.in/pdf/profile/goutam-patra/kothari%20commission.pdf
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Planning
Subtopic:)

Q.24) Consider the following statements:
Statement I: An inverted duty structure can lead to cash flow shortages and liquidity issues for manufacturers.
Statement II: Under an inverted duty structure, the tax rate on inputs is higher than the tax rate on finished goods, resulting in the accumulation of unutilized Input Tax Credit (ITC).
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

Ans) a

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement I is correct: An **inverted duty structure** can **create cash flow shortages and liquidity problems for manufacturers,** because a portion of their working capital remains blocked in the form of unutilized tax credit.

Statement II is correct: An **inverted duty structure arises** when the **tax rate** (such as GST) on **inputs is higher** than the **tax rate on finished goods**, which leads to the accumulation of unutilized Input Tax Credit (ITC) with manufacturers.

Statement II explains Statement I: Since manufacturers pay more tax on inputs than they collect on output supplies, the excess ITC cannot be fully utilized against the lower output tax liability, resulting in the accumulation of credit and blocking of working capital, thereby causing liquidity issues.

Therefore, **Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I.**

Source:) https://legal.economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/law-policy/inverted-duty-structure-requires-reform-for-domestic-manufacturer-and-global-competitiveness/113051873

https://www.thehindu.com/business/Economy/centre-proposes-fewer-gst-rates-only-5-18-to-remain-tax-on-common-use-items-slashed/article69937407.ece

https://indianexpress.com/article/business/economy/gst-inversion-eases-but-wide-gap-in-input-output-rates-remains-a-worry-for-industry-10236219/

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Taxation

Subtopic:)

Q.25) The "MISHTI" initiative of the Government of India is primarily aimed at:

a) regeneration and restoration of coral reefs.

b) production of biofuel using agricultural wastes.

c) restoration and conservation of mangrove ecosystems.

d) reduction of greenhouse gas emissions.

Ans) c

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

The Mangrove Initiative for Shoreline Habitats & Tangible Incomes (MISHTI) scheme is a government-led initiative **aimed at increasing the mangrove cover along the coastline and on salt pan lands.** "MISHTI" comes after India joined the 'Mangrove Alliance for Climate' launched during the 27th Conference of Parties (COP27) to the UNFCCC held in Egypt in November 2022.

It was launched by the Ministry of Environment, Forest & Climate Change on the occasion of World Environment Day, i.e., 5th June 2023.

MISHTI envisages the restoration/reforestation of mangroves covering approximately 540 sq.km., spreading across 9 states and 3 union territories for a period of five years commencing 2023-24 onwards.

Under the MISHTI scheme, the government is providing financial assistance to local communities to undertake mangrove plantation activities.

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025), Page: 60-61

Subject:) Current Affairs

Topic:) Environment

Subtopic:)

Q.26) Consider the following initiatives:

I. Atal Innovation Mission

II. Aspirational District Programme/Aspirational Block Programme

III. Bharat Startup Knowledge Access Registry (BHASKAR)

IV. Women Entrepreneurship Platform

Which of the above are initiatives of the National Institution for Transforming India (NITI Aayog)?

a) I and II only

b) III and IV only

c) I, II and IV only
d) I, II, III and IV

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Option I is correct: The Atal Innovation Mission (AIM) was established in 2016 by NITI Aayog as the Government of India's flagship **initiative to promote a culture of innovation and entrepreneurship.**
Option II is correct: The Aspirational Districts Programme (ADP) is an initiative of NITI Aayog. It aims to **quickly and effectively transform 112 most under-developed districts across the country**.
Aspirational Blocks Programme (ABP) is a NITI Aayog initiative aimed at improving development in 500 of India's most underdeveloped blocks across 27 states and 4 UTs. It focuses on enhancing quality of life through 3Cs: Convergence of schemes, Collaboration, and Competition.
Option III is incorrect: The Bharat Startup Knowledge Access Registry (BHASKAR) is a digital platform **launched under the Startup India initiative by the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade** under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry. It is designed as a one-stop platform to enable various stakeholders of the startup ecosystem such as entrepreneurs, investors, incubators, and mentors to connect, collaborate, and share knowledge.
Option IV is correct: The Women Entrepreneurship Platform (WEP) was launched in 2017 by NITI Aayog during the Global Entrepreneurship Summit 2017. It functions as a one-stop platform that **supports women entrepreneurs by providing access to mentorship, funding opportunities, and networking**.
Source:
https://aim.gov.in/overview.php
https://niti.gov.in/aspirational-districts-programme
https://www.startupindia.gov.in/
https://www.niti.gov.in/sites/default/files/2023-03/Decoding-Government-Support-to-Women-Entrepreneurs-in-India.pdf
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Planning
Subtopic:)

Q.27) Consider the following statements:
The Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council shall make recommendations to the Union and States on:
I. the standard GST rates applicable on specific goods and services.
II. the goods and services that may be subjected to, or exempted from GST.
III. the threshold limit of turnover below which goods and services may be exempt from GST.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) I and III only
d) I, II and III

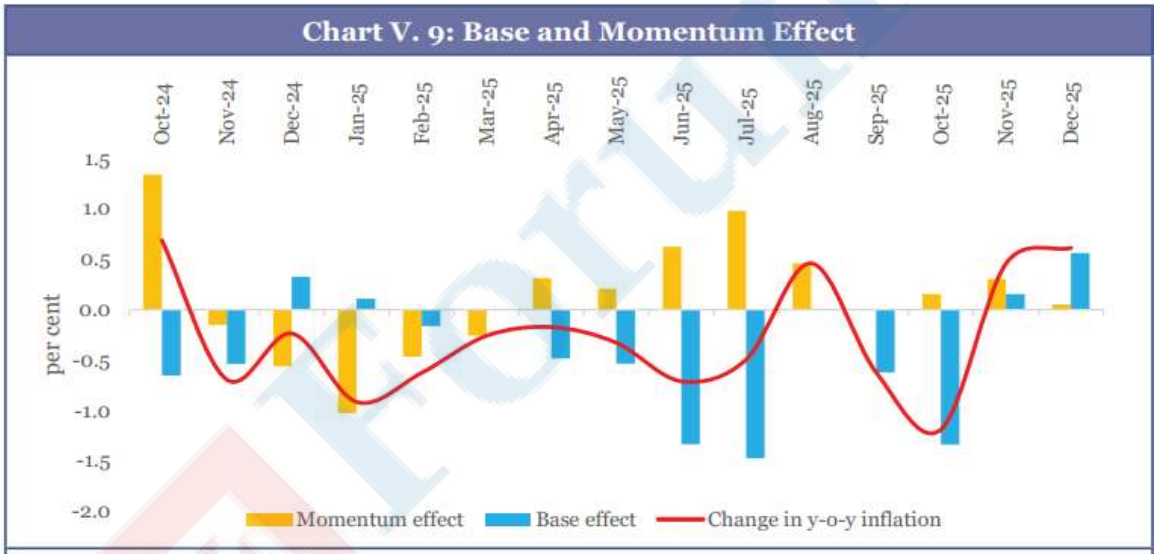
Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
The **Goods and Services Tax Council** is a **constitutional body** established under **Article 279A** of the Constitution by the **101st Constitutional Amendment Act**. It serves as the apex federal decision-making body for the Goods and Services Tax (GST) in India, ensuring coordination between the Union and the States on GST-related matters.

- The Council is **chaired by the Union Finance Minister.**
- Its **primary role is to make recommendations on key aspects of GST**, including tax rates, exemptions, threshold limits, model GST laws, and special provisions for States, thereby promoting a harmonised and uniform indirect tax structure across the country.

Option I is correct: Under Article 279A of the Constitution, the **GST Council recommends the GST rates** (including standard rates, special rates, and floor rates) applicable on goods and services.
Option II is correct: Under Article 279A of the Constitution, the GST **Council recommends** which **goods and services may be subjected to GST or exempted from GST,** including exemptions for specific sectors or categories.
Option III is correct: Under Article 279A of the Constitution, the GST Council **recommends the threshold limit of turnover below which goods and services may be exempt from GST.**
Source:) https://gstcouncil.gov.in/gst-council-0
https://www.gstcouncil.gov.in/sites/default/files/2024-02/procedure_conduct_business.pdf
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.28) In the context of inflation, the momentum effect reflects/captures the:
a) the impact of price levels from the previous year's base period on the current year-on-year inflation calculation.
b) the inflationary pressure caused by an increase in the speed at which money circulates in the economy.
c) the sudden spikes in food and fuel prices driven specifically by supply-side shocks.
d) month-on-month price changes in the current year.

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
The momentum effect in inflation refers to the carry-forward impact of recent month-to-month price changes within the current year on the present inflation rate. It captures short-term persistence in inflation, where recent price movements continue to influence the current inflation reading.
The momentum effect captures the month-on-month price changes in the current year.



Source: Calculated from the CPI

Knowledge Base: **Base Effect (in Inflation):**
The base effect refers to the **influence of price movements in the corresponding months of the previous year on the current year-on-year inflation rate**, which can make inflation appear higher or lower depending on last year's price levels.
Source:) https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/economicsurvey/doc/eschapter/echap05.pdf Page: 210.
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Economic Survey 2025-26
Subtopic:)

Q.29) In the context of an economy, the term 'biflation' refers to the simultaneous occurrence of:
a) Inflation and unemployment.

b) Demand-pull inflation and cost-push inflation.
c) Rising prices of goods and services in both domestic and global markets.
d) Inflation and deflation.

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Biflation refers to the simultaneous occurrence of inflation in some sectors of the economy **and deflation** in others. For example, prices of essential goods or assets such as housing may rise while prices of discretionary consumer goods decline.
This phenomenon can be explained through the **Cantillon effect**, named after Richard Cantillon. The Cantillon effect suggests that changes in money supply do not affect all prices uniformly. **When central banks expand the money supply** or alter interest rates, the newly created money enters the economy through specific channels first (such as financial institutions or asset markets). As a result, **relative prices change unevenly across sectors**, causing inflation in some areas while others may experience stagnant or falling prices.
Source: Indian Economy by Ramesh Singh (16th Ed)- Ch: 20 – Glossary- Pg: 460"
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Inflation
Subtopic:)

Q.30) With reference to the Wetland City Accreditation (WCA), recently seen in news, consider the following statements:
I. This Accreditation is provided under the World Heritage Convention of United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO).
II. Vadnagar and Jaipur have become the first two Indian cities to achieve the Wetland City Accreditation.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Wetland City Accreditation (WCA) is a voluntary accreditation system that recognizes cities committed to conserving their natural or human-made wetlands. It offers international recognition and positive publicity for their efforts.
Statement I is incorrect. Wetland City Accreditation **is a voluntary accreditation system established by the Ramsar Convention.**
WCA was introduced during the 12th Conference of the Parties (COP12) to the Ramsar Convention held in Uruguay in 2015.
To receive Wetland City Accreditation, a city must meet the six international criteria set by the Ramsar Convention. Once granted, it is valid for a period of 6 years.
Statement II is incorrect. Indore and Udaipur have become the first Indian cities to achieve the prestigious Wetland City Accreditation (WCA) under the Ramsar Convention on Wetlands.

- **Indore:** Sirpur Lake (a Ramsar Site) is recognized for its water bird congregation and is being developed into a bird sanctuary.
- Udaipur: Encircled by five major wetlands—Pichola, Fateh Sagar, Rang Sagar, Swaroop Sagar, and Doodh Talai.

Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025), Page: 54
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Q.31) Which of the following statements is/are true with respect to Phillips Curve?
1. It shows the trade-off between unemployment and inflation.

2. The downward sloping curve of Phillips curve is generally held to be valid only in the short run.
3. In the long run, Phillips Curve is usually thought to be horizontal at the Non-Accelerating Inflation Rate of Unemployment (NAIRU).
Select the correct answer using the codes given below
a) 2 and 3 only
b) Only 1
c) 1 and 2 only
d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement 1 is correct- The original Phillips Curve suggests an **inverse relationship between unemployment and inflation**. When unemployment is high, inflation tends to be low, and vice versa.
Statement 2 is correct- In the short run, there is often an **inverse relationship between unemployment and inflation.** This is because in the short term, changes in aggregate demand can lead to shifts along the Phillips Curve. However, in the long run, the relationship becomes less stable due to various factors such as changes in inflation expectations, supply-side shocks, and wage-price dynamics.
Statement 3 is incorrect- The **NAIRU represents the level of unemployment** at which inflation remains stable. In the long run, the Phillips Curve may shift vertically rather than being completely horizontal, indicating that unemployment can have different equilibrium levels at different inflation rates.
Source: UPSC CDS [I] 2016
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Inflation
Subtopic:)

Q.32) Consider the following statements in respect of NITI Aayog and erstwhile Planning Commission:
I. Unlike NITI Aayog , the Planning Commission was a statutory body.
II. Unlike the Planning commission, the Union Ministers can be members of NITI Aayog.
III. Unlike the Planning commission, NITI Aayog does not have the power to allocate funds to ministries and state governments.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
a) I and II only
b) III only
c) II and III only
d) None of the Above

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
The National Institution for Transforming India (NITI) Aayog is an institution that serves as a Think Tank of the government, providing directional and policy inputs. NITI Aayog was formed to replace the Planning Commission in 2015.
Statement I is incorrect: The **Planning Commission was an extra-constitutional** (i.e., non-constitutional) and **non-statutory body** created by the executive resolution of the Government of India. Similarly, **NITI Aayog is also neither a constitutional body nor a statutory body.** In other words, it is a non-constitutional or extra-constitutional body (i.e., not created by the Constitution) and a non-statutory body (not created by an Act of the Parliament).
Statement II is incorrect: Both NITI Aayog and the Planning Commission include Union Ministers as members. The Planning Commission had a flexible membership structure and included several Union Cabinet Ministers as ex-officio members along with a Member Secretary and other experts appointed by the government. The composition of **NITI Aayog includes ex-officio members, with up to four Union Ministers from the Council of Ministers nominated by the Prime Minister**.

Statement III is correct: The Planning Commission had the **authority to allocate plan funds to ministries and State Governments** and could influence state policies by linking financial assistance to approved projects. NITI Aayog, however, **does not have the mandate to impose policies on States and does not possess the power to allocate funds**.
Source:) https://niti.gov.in/
Indian Economy, Ramesh Singh, Chapter - 05, Planning in India
https://niti.gov.in/about-us/objectives-and-features
Indian Polity, Laxmikanth, Chapter - 54, NITI Aayog
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Planning
Subtopic:)

Q.33) The Wage Rate Index (WRI) in India is compiled and maintained by:
a) National Statistical Office (NSO)
b) Labour Bureau
c) NITI Aayog
d) Reserve Bank of India

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
The **Wage Rate Index (WRI)** is an economic indicator that shows how **wage rates of workers change over time** in different industries. It helps policymakers, researchers, and businesses understand trends in wages and labour costs across sectors of the economy. The Labour Bureau, functioning under the Ministry of Labour and Employment, is responsible for **compiling and maintaining the Wage Rate Index in India**. The current WRI series has **2016 as the base year (2016=100)** and covers **37 industries**, including manufacturing, mining, and plantation sectors.
Source:) https://labourbureau.gov.in/wri
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Inflation
Subtopic:)

Q.34) With reference to the Indian economy, cost-push inflation can be caused/increased by which of the following?
I. Rise in global oil prices
II. Decreasing interest rates in the economy.
III. Increase in wages
IV. Increase in the government spending
Select the correct answer using the code given below:
a) I and III only
b) II and IV only
c) I, III and IV
d) I, II and III

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Cost-push inflation refers to a situation where the general price level rises due to an increase in the cost of production. As the prices of key inputs increase, producers raise the prices of goods and services that depend on these inputs. Consequently, inflation is triggered from the supply side, as higher production costs reduce the effective supply of goods in the economy.
Option I is correct: Rise in global oil prices is going to affect the production cost. It may increase the production cost thus can **cause cost-push inflation** in the economy.
Option II is incorrect: Decreasing interest rates in the economy can cause **demand-pull inflation, not cost-push inflation. Decreasing interest rates typically stimulate borrowing and spending, leading to increased demand for goods and services and pushing prices up due to increased demand.**

Option III is correct: Increasing wages raises labour costs which will increase the production cost resulting in cost push inflation in an economy.

Option IV is incorrect: When the **government increases spending**, it typically increases demand for goods and services, which can push prices up due to increased demand rather than increased production costs. It **can lead to demand-pull inflation rather than cost-push inflation.**

Source: https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/definition/cost-push-inflation?from=mdr
https://www.egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/67663/3/Unit-8.pdf Pg: 99 & 100
https://www.imf.org/en/publications/fandd/issues/series/back-to-basics/inflation
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Inflation
Subtopic:)

Q.35) Which one of the following correctly describes the "Wallace Line"?
a) A geographical boundary that marks significant climatic variation between the tropics and temperate regions.
b) A geographical boundary that marks the distinct difference in the distribution of flora and fauna between the regions of Asia and Australia.
c) A marine region characterized by high coral reef diversity separating the Indian and Pacific oceans.
d) A tectonic boundary separating the Eurasian and Australian continental plates.

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
The **Wallace Line**, named after English naturalist **Alfred Russel Wallace**. **Wallace line is a geographical boundary that marks a distinct difference in the distribution of flora and fauna between the regions of Asia and Australia**. It distinguishes two markedly different groups of animals–Asian fauna such as **tigers and orangutans** to the west, and Australian fauna such as **kangaroos and cockatoos** to the east. This line passes primarily between **Bali and Lombok**, extending northward between **Borneo and Sulawesi**. The Wallace Line highlights how geographic isolation and geological history influence the evolution and distribution of species
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Q.36) Consider the following statements:
Statement I: Lenders/Creditors are generally negatively impacted by inflation.
Statement II: Inflation erodes the purchasing power of money over time.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I
b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct, but Statement II does not explain Statement I
c) Statement I is correct, but Statement II is not correct
d) Statement I is not correct, but Statement-II is correct

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.
Inflation refers to a sustained increase in the general price level of goods and services in an economy over time.
Statement I is correct. When lenders/creditors provide loans, they expect to receive repayments with interest in the future. However, if inflation rises during this period, the **real value of the money they receive back becomes lower** than the value of the money they originally lent. As a result, lenders are negatively impacted during inflation.
Statement II is correct. Inflation means that **prices of goods and services increase**, so the same amount of money can buy **fewer goods and services** over time. In other words, the **purchasing power of money declines**.
Statement II is the correct explanation for statement I. Since inflation reduces the purchasing power of money, the money repaid to lenders in the future is **worth less in real terms**, which is why lenders are negatively affected.

Source:) Ramesh Singh, Chapter 7- INflation and Business cycle, Page 190
https://indianexpress.com/article/explained/rising-inflation-cause-effect-explained-7915202/
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Inflation
Subtopic:)

Q.37) In the context of public finance, a Pigouvian tax primarily refers to a tax imposed to:
a) Encourage the consumption of merit goods by lowering their effective prices.
b) Discourage activities that generate negative externalities.
c) Redistribute income from high-income to low-income groups.
d) Provide fiscal incentives to promote exports of manufactured goods.

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
A **Pigouvian tax** is a **tax imposed on activities that generate negative externalities,** that is, costs imposed on society that are not reflected in the market price of the goods or services.
The concept was proposed by the **British economist Arthur Cecil Pigou** in his work ***The Economics of Welfare.*** Pigou argued that when a market activity causes social harm (for example pollution), the government should impose a tax equal to the marginal social cost of that harm.
This tax internalizes the externality, meaning it forces producers or consumers to take into account the broader social costs of their actions. As a result, the market outcome moves closer to the socially optimal level of production or consumption.
Examples:

- **Carbon tax on greenhouse gas emissions**
- **Taxes on cigarettes or alcohol**
- **Pollution taxes on industries**

These taxes discourage harmful activities and **help correct market failure caused by negative externalities.**
Source:) https://www.egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/61602/1/Unit-18.pdf Page: 47.
https://m.economictimes.com/news/economy/policy/tax-private-capital-flows-to-guard-against-volatility-survey/articleshow/4729087.cms
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.38) In the context of certain terms seen in the news, consider the following pairs:

Term	Description
I. Shrinkflation	A situation marked by rising prices in only a few sectors of the economy.
II. Stagflation	An economic situation marked by stagnant economic output and high price inflation.
III. Disinflation	An economic situation where there is a consistent decline in price level.
IV. Skewflation	It occurs when there is reduction in the quantity or size of a product but consumers still pay the earlier price.

How many of the pairs given above are correctly matched?
a) Only one
b) Only two
c) Only three
d) All the four

Ans) a

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Pair I is incorrect: Shrinkflation is when a product downsizes its quantity while keeping the price the same (not price rise in a few sectors.). For example, reducing the scoops of ice cream in a container or reducing the number of chips in a packet would count as shrinkflation. In other words, shrinkflation occurs when goods shrink in size but consumers pay the same price.

Pair II is correct: Stagflation refers to a situation where an economy experiences **very slow or stagnant economic growth along with rising prices**. In such a condition, the economy faces high inflation despite weak or negligible growth, and it is often accompanied by increasing unemployment.

Pair III is incorrect: Disinflation refers to a decrease in the rate of inflation, meaning that the overall increase in prices of goods and services is slowing down but prices are still rising. **Decline in the average price of goods and services is known as Deflation.**

Pair IV is incorrect: Skewflation refers to a situation where **inflation is concentrated in specific sectors or commodities of the economy rather than being widespread across all sectors**. For example, prices of food items may rise sharply while prices in other sectors remain relatively stable.

Source: https://www.thehindu.com/specials/text-and-context/shrinkflation/article65918802.ece
https://egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/73891/1/Unit-7.pdf - Page no 78
https://www.indiabudget.gov.in/budget_archive/es2009-10/chapt2010/chapter02.pdf - Page no 32
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Inflation
Subtopic:)

Q.39) With reference to the Reverse Charge Mechanism (RCM) under the Goods and Services Tax (GST) in India, consider the following statements:

I. Under it, the liability to pay tax is on the recipient of supply of goods or services instead of the supplier of such goods or services in respect of notified categories of supply.

II. A person who is required to pay tax under the reverse charge has to register under GST only if the annual turnover is more than 40 lakhs.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) a

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Statement I is correct. Under the **Goods and Services Tax (GST)** system, the normal rule is that the **supplier of goods or services is responsible for paying the tax to the government**. However, in certain specified cases, the responsibility to pay tax is shifted to the **recipient of the goods or services**. This arrangement is known as the **Reverse Charge Mechanism (RCM)**.

Statement II is incorrect. The GST law requires that **any person liable to pay tax under reverse charge must obtain GST registration**, even if their turnover is below the usual exemption threshold. The exemption limit to register to GST was exceeded in 2025 for normal category states for the sale of goods below 40 lakhs and for services below 20 lakhs. But this exemption limit is not applicable in case of a person liable to pay tax under reverse charge, they must compulsorily register.

Source:) https://gstcouncil.gov.in/sites/default/files/e-version-gst-flyers/Reverse%20charge%20Mechanism.pdf
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Inflation
Subtopic:)

Q.40) With reference to the Commission on Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture (CGRFA), consider the following statements:
I. It is the only permanent intergovernmental body that addresses biological diversity for food and agriculture.
II. It operates under the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) of the United Nations.
III. It works to ensure fair and equitable sharing of benefits derived from the use of genetic resources.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and III only
b) I and II only
c) II and III only
d) I, II and III

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Statement I is correct. Commission on Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture (CGRFA) is **the only permanent intergovernmental body that addresses the components of biological diversity for food and agriculture.**
India is a member.
Statement II is correct. It operates **under the Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO)** of the United Nations.
Statement III is correct. It aims to reach international consensus on policies for the sustainable use and conservation of genetic resources for food and agriculture and **the fair and equitable sharing of benefits derived from their use.**
The 20th meeting of the Commission on Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture (CGRFA-20) took place in Rome.
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025), Page: 56-57
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Q.41) Core inflation is :
a) CPI headline inflation minus all non-food items
b) WPI inflation minus all food and non-food items
c) CPI headline inflation minus food and energy items
d) WPI inflation minus food and energy items

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer
Core inflation is a measure of inflation that excludes volatile categories to analyze underlying price trends. It is the change in the costs of goods and services but does not include those from the food and energy sectors. **Thus it is specifically defined as CPI headline minus the impact of food and energy (fuel and power) products.**
Source: UPSC CDS [I] 2025
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Inflation
Subtopic:)

Q.42) In the context of financial transactions in India, which one of the following taxes is levied on foreign currency conversion transactions?
a) Goods and Services Tax (GST)
b) Securities Transaction Tax (STT)
c) Commodities Transaction Tax (CTT)
d) Short Term Capital Gains Tax (STCG)

Ans) a
Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Option a is correct: When an individual or business converts **Indian Rupees into a foreign currency or vice versa**, the transaction is carried out through **banks or authorised money changers**. These intermediaries provide a **currency exchange service** and charge a **margin or service fee** for the transaction.

In India, this **currency conversion service is taxed under the Goods and Services Tax (GST) framework**. GST is not levied on the value of the currency itself. Instead, it is imposed on the **service component or margin charged by the bank or authorised dealer** during the conversion process. For instance, if a bank converts rupees into US dollars and charges a service margin, **GST is applied to that margin**.

Option b is incorrect: Securities Transaction Tax (STT) is levied on buying and selling securities such as shares, equity derivatives, and equity mutual funds on recognised stock exchanges.

Option c is incorrect: Commodity Transaction Tax (CTT) is a direct tax in India levied on non-agricultural commodity derivatives trading on recognized exchanges.

Option d is incorrect: Short-Term Capital Gains Tax (STCG) applies when a capital asset such as shares, mutual funds, or property is sold within a short holding period and generates a gain.

Source: https://economictimes.indiatimes.com/wealth/spend/planning-an-international-trip-now-get-forex-delivered-to-your-doorstep-with-pay-on-delivery-available-even-on-weekends/articleshow/125761729.cms?from=mdr

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Taxation

Subtopic:)

Q.43) Consider the following statements:

Statement I: Unlike Ad valorem taxes, specific taxes automatically adjust to inflation.

Statement II: Specific taxes are levied on the goods and services on per unit basis, whereas ad valorem taxes are levied as a percentage of the value of the good or service.

Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?

a) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct and Statement II explains Statement I

b) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct but Statement II does not explain Statement I

c) Statement I is correct but Statement II is not correct

d) Statement I is not correct but Statement II is correct

Ans) d

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Statement I is incorrect: Specific taxes do not automatically adjust with inflation, whereas **ad valorem taxes tend to increase with rising prices.**

- A **specific tax** is **imposed as a fixed monetary amount per unit** (e.g., ₹20 per litre). If inflation increases the price of the commodity, the tax per unit remains unchanged unless revised by the government.
- An **ad valorem tax is imposed as a percentage of value** (e.g., 18%). When prices rise due to inflation, the tax amount also increases automatically because it is linked to value.

Statement II is correct: Specific taxes are **levied as a fixed amount per unit of a good or service** (e.g., ₹5 per litre, ₹100 per pack)., whereas **ad valorem taxes** are **levied as a percentage of the value of the good or service** (e.g., 18% GST, 10% customs duty).

Source:) https://www.egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/59901/3/Unit-10.pdf Page: 157.

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Taxation

Subtopic:)

Q.44) Which among the following Five Year plans was also referred to as Mahalanobis Plan?

a) First Five Year plan

b) Second Five Year Plan

c) Third Five Year Plan

d) Fourth Five Year Plan

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer
Option a is incorrect: The First Five-Year Plan was based on the Harrod-Domar Model, which emphasizes capital accumulation and investment for economic growth.
Option b is correct: The **Second Five Year Plan (1956–61)** was based on the **Mahalanobis model**, which emphasised the development of **heavy and capital goods industries** to accelerate long-term economic growth. Hence, **it is also called Mahalanobis Plan.**
The Second plan was conceived in an atmosphere of economic stability. It was felt **agriculture could be accorded lower priority.** The Plan Focussed on **rapid industrialization- heavy and basic industries. Advocated huge imports through foreign loans.** The Industrial Policy 1956 was based on the establishment of a socialistic pattern of society as the goal of economic policy.
Option c is incorrect: Third Five Year Plan at its conception, was felt that Indian economy has entered a "takeoff stage". Therefore, its aim was to make India a 'self-reliant' and 'self-generating' economy.
Option d is incorrect: Fourth Five Year Plan twin objectives were " growth with stability " and "progressive achievement of self reliance'.
Source: https://www.mospi.gov.in/sites/default/files/Statistical_year_book_india_chapters/ch7.pdf (page 2 and 3)
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Planning
Subtopic:)

Q.45) The term 'TrailGuard AI System' is sometimes seen in the news in the context of
a) Providing navigational services in emergency
b) Provision of weather forecasting services
c) Improving the vision of railway loco pilots
d) Prevention of human-wildlife conflicts

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
TrailGuard AI System is an anti-poaching tool. It is an e**nd-to-end, camera-based alert system** designed for enhancing wildlife conservation and **promoting human-wildlife coexistence** in remote areas.
It autonomously detects target objects and transmits real-time alerts that can trigger rapid response to entry by poachers or illegal loggers, wildlife entering agricultural or pastoral lands, or status of endangered or exotic invasive species. It transmits human and wildlife activities in remote areas in under 30 seconds, enabling real-time interventions
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Q.46) Consider the following:
I. People's Plan by M.N. Roy
II. Sarvodaya Plan by Jaiprakash Narayan
III. Visvesvaraya Plan by M. Visvesvaraya
Arrange the above initiatives with respect to planning in pre Independent India in the chronological order:
a) I - II - III
b) II - I - III
c) II - III - I
d) III - I - II

Ans) d

Exp) Option d is the correct answer.

Option d is correct: The correct chronological order of the above-mentioned plans in terms of their year of publication: **Visvesvaraya Plan (1934) - People's Plan (1945) - Sarvodaya Plan (1950).**

Option III: Visvesvaraya Plan (1934): Proposed by M. Visvesvaraya, this plan focused on shifting workers from agriculture to industrial sectors.

Option I: The **People's Plan** was prepared by **M. N. Roy in 1945** and was associated with the **Post-War Reconstruction Committee** of the Indian Trade Union. The plan advocated socialist economic policies and was influenced by Marxist ideas. It proposed nationalisation of key industries, large-scale industrialisation, and extensive state control over economic resources. The primary objective of the plan was to ensure the provision of the **basic necessities of life** to all citizens.

Option II: Sarvodaya Plan (1950): The **Sarvodaya Plan** was formulated by **Jayaprakash Narayan in 1950**. Inspired by the **Gandhian philosophy of Sarvodaya (welfare of all)**, the plan emphasized decentralized planning, rural development, and self-sufficient village communities. It focused on agricultural development, land reforms, and promotion of small-scale industries.

Source:) https://egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/116050/1/Unit-1.pdf (Pg. 14)

Indian Economy - ForumIAS RedBook, 1st Edition, Chapter - 09, Planning in India, Pg. 127 - 128

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Planning

Subtopic:)

Q.47) Which of the following steps are most likely to be taken by the Government of India/Reserve Bank of India during deflationary conditions?

I. Decrease in Income tax rates and corporation tax rates

II. Increasing the interest rates of small saving schemes

III. Decreasing the repo rate

IV. Selling of government securities

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

a) I and III only

b) II and IV only

c) I, II and III only

d) I, II, III and IV

Ans) a

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Deflation refers to a persistent decline in the general price level in an economy. It occurs when aggregate demand is lower than aggregate supply. As a result, deflation is typically associated with reduced production, rising unemployment, and an overall slowdown in economic activity.

Option I is correct: Reducing taxes increases **disposable income of individuals and firms**, encouraging consumption and investment which helps in **increasing demand to overcome the deflationary situation in an economy.**

Option II is incorrect: Increasing the rate of interest on small saving schemes would likely not be adopted to fight deflation, as it would discourage borrowing and spending, further dampening economic activity. Central banks typically lower interest rates to encourage borrowing and investment during deflationary periods.

Option III is correct: Decreasing the repo rate decreases the overall borrowing cost of commercial banks. It helps the household and firms to avail the cheaper loans from the bank and in turn increases money supply and demand in the market which helps to address the deflation in an economy.

Option IV is incorrect: Selling government securities through **Open Market Operations (OMOs)** absorbs liquidity from the economy. **During deflation, the central bank usually buys securities** to **inject liquidity.**

Source: https://egyankosh.ac.in/bitstream/123456789/62756/1/Block-8.pdf page no 21.

Subject:) Economy

Topic:) Inflation

Subtopic:)

Q.48) With reference to the Securities Transaction Tax (STT) in India, consider the following statements:
I. It is an example of direct tax.
II. It is levied on every purchase and sale of securities listed on a recognised stock exchange, irrespective of whether the transaction results in a profit or a loss.
III. The liability to collect and remit STT lies with the recognized intermediaries through which the transaction is executed.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I and II only
b) II and III only
c) I and III only
d) I, II and III

Ans) d
Exp) Option d is the correct answer.
Statement I is correct: Securities Transaction Tax (STT) is a **direct tax levied by the Central Government** on transactions in specified securities carried out on recognised stock exchanges in India. It was **introduced by the Finance Act, 2004**.
Statement II is correct: STT is **levied** on the **value of every taxable purchase or sale of securities** (such as equity shares, derivatives, and equity-oriented mutual funds) **executed on recognised stock exchanges.** It is **levied irrespective** of whether the **investor makes a profit or incurs a loss,** since the **tax is linked to the transaction value rather than income or gains**.
The tax is triggered simply by the buying or selling of eligible securities through a recognised stock exchange.
Statement III is correct: The **tax is collected at** the **time of** the **transaction** by the **recognized stock exchange, clearing corporation, or mutual fund**, depending on the nature of the transaction. These intermediaries then **remit the collected STT to** the **Central Government**.
Source:) https://www.sebi.gov.in/sebi_data/docfiles/20615_t.html
https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/business/india-business/stt-hike-after-budget-2026-what-is-securities-transaction-tax-what-does-it-mean-for-fo-traders-and-investors/articleshow/127839884.cms
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.49) With reference to the Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT), consider the following statements:
I. It is a statutory body.
II. It notifies Cost Inflation Index (CII) annually
Which of the statements given above are correct?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement I is correct: The **Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) is a statutory authority** constituted under the Central Board of Revenue Act, 1963. It **consists of a Chairman and following six Members:** Member (Administration), Member (Income Tax), Member (Systems & Faceless Assessment Scheme), Member (Tax Payer Services & Revenue), Member (Audit & Judicial) and Member (Legislation)
Statement II is correct: Central Board of Direct Taxes (CBDT) notifies the Cost Inflation Index (CII) annually. Cost Inflation Index is used by taxpayers to compute gains arising out of sale of capital assets after adjusting inflation.

Source:) https://incometaxindia.gov.in/Documents/departmental-directory.pdf (Pg. 309 - 310)
https://www.pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2195261&reg=3&lang=2
https://www.newsonair.gov.in/cbdt-notifies-cost-inflation-index-for-financial-year-2024-25/?noshow=1
Subject:) Economy
Topic:) Taxation
Subtopic:)

Q.50) Under which of the following situations, one can say that the phenomena of 'Biodiversity Leak' has occurred?
a) When an ecosystem can no longer sustain a population without causing environmental degradation.
b) When biodiversity declines more quickly inside protected areas as compared to outside areas.
c) When conservation efforts in some nations lead to biodiversity loss in other nations.
d) When the focus rests primarily on the conservation of specific species rather than preserving the entire ecosystem.

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Restoration and rewilding programs in agricultural landscapes in some nations can incentivise production expansion in other countries, thus driving biodiversity loss in latter and causing a 'net harm'. This phenomenon is referred to as 'biodiversity leak'. In this process **conservation policies in one region inadvertently drive environmental degradation in another region.**
Conservation and restoration efforts in some nations may reduce food or fibre production. This, in turn, could lead to an increase in production activities in more biodiverse regions elsewhere. This phenomenon is referred to as 'biodiversity leak'.
Source: SFG ESSENTIAL, CURRENT AFFAIRS, QUARTERLY COMPILATION (JANUARY– MARCH 2025)
Subject:) Current Affairs
Topic:) Environment
Subtopic:)

Directions for the following 4 (four) items:
Read the following three passages and answer the items that follow the passages. Your answers to these items should be based on the passages only

Passage - 1

India's entry into the Pax Silica alliance is a strategic effort to secure its technological future by aligning with a U.S.-led coalition focused on AI infrastructure and critical minerals. Although India currently lacks significant capacity in the extraction and processing of critical minerals, it holds considerable strengths elsewhere. It contributes nearly 20% of global chip design engineering talent and possesses substantial electronics assembly capabilities, both of which are critical for diversifying global technology supply chains. Through participation in this ecosystem, India will seek to secure access to raw materials and advanced manufacturing equipment. Membership in the alliance will also advance domestic industrial objectives by reinforcing initiatives such as India Semiconductor, India AI Mission, and the National Critical Minerals Mission. Together, these could strengthen India's position in AI and critical mineral value chains.

Q.51) Which one of the following statements best reflects the most logical and rational inference that can be drawn from the passage?
a) Contemporary geopolitics revolves around securing critical mineral supply chains.
b) India's entry into the Pax Silica alliance will give a major boost to India's domestic manufacturing sector.
c) While India is not a major producer of critical minerals, it can play a pivotal role in securing supply chains as a member of Pax Silica.
d) India needs to strengthen its domestic infrastructure for critical mineral extraction in order to benefit from its membership in the Pax Silica alliance.

Ans) c

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

Statement a is incorrect. The passage states "India's entry into the Pax Silica alliance is a strategic effort to secure its technological future by aligning with a U.S.-led coalition focused on AI infrastructure and critical minerals." However, statement a does not best reflect the most logical and rational inference that can be drawn from the passage as it is a **general statement and does not focus on India.**

Statement b is incorrect. While the passage states "Membership in the alliance will also advance domestic industrial objectives by reinforcing initiatives such as India Semiconductor, India AI Mission, and the National Critical Minerals Mission", statement a does not best reflect the most logical and rational inference that can be drawn from the passage as it **highlights only one of the benefits of India's membership of Pax Silica.**

Statement c is correct. It best reflects the most logical and rational inference that can be drawn from the passage as it **comprehensively highlights India's role as a member of Pax Silica**. It is mentioned in the passage as "Although India currently lacks significant capacity in the extraction and processing of critical minerals, it holds considerable strengths elsewhere. It contributes nearly 20% of global chip design engineering talent and possesses substantial electronics assembly capabilities, both of which are critical for diversifying global technology supply chains."

Statement d is incorrect. The **passage does not explicitly mention** that India needs to strengthen its domestic infrastructure for critical mineral extraction in order to benefit from its membership in the Pax Silica alliance.

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Reading Comprehension

Subtopic:)

Q.52) With reference to above passage, the following assumptions have been made:

I. India's entry into the Pax Silica alliance will transform it into a leader in critical mineral value chains by 2035.

II. India's technological talent base constitutes one of its core strategic assets.

Which of the above assumptions is/are valid?

a) I only

b) II only

c) Both I and II

d) Neither I nor II

Ans) b

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

Statement I is incorrect. While the passage states that India's entry into Pax Silica will strengthen its position in critical mineral value chain, it would be **outside the scope of the passage to assume that India would emerge as a leader in critical mineral value chain by 2035**.

Statement II is correct. The passage states "**Although India currently lacks significant capacity in the extraction and processing of critical minerals, it holds considerable strengths elsewhere. It contributes nearly 20% of global chip design engineering talent**." From here, we can conclude that assumption II is correct.

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Reading Comprehension

Subtopic:)

Passage - 2

The development and deployment of emerging technologies have long been approached with caution because of their dual-use nature i.e., their capacity to generate both beneficial and harmful applications. This characteristic creates a dilemma with significant policy implications, as efforts to advance innovation can simultaneously raise concerns about misuse. Such dynamics can heighten tensions and fuel competitive cycles among states. For example, the infrastructure, materials, tools, and expertise used to develop vaccines or conduct genomic surveillance during disease outbreaks can also be redirected for manufacturing biological weapons. As a result, distinguishing between activities intended to strengthen public health security and those that could be exploited by malicious actors is becoming increasingly difficult.

Q.53) Based on the above passage, the following assumptions have been made:
I. Governments should curb the development and use of dual-use technologies.
II. Policy makers need to ensure that dual-use technologies are utilized for the benefit of the public.
Which of the assumptions given above is/are valid?
a) I only
b) II only
c) Both I and II
d) Neither I nor II

Ans) b
Exp) Option b is the correct answer.
Statement I is invalid. While the passage highlights the risks emanating from the development of dual use technologies, it does not explicitly state that governments should curb their use. **Therefore, the assumption is outside the scope of the passage and therefore incorrect.**
Statement II is valid. The passage states "The development and deployment of emerging technologies have long been approached with caution because of their dual-use nature i.e., their capacity to generate both beneficial and harmful applications. This **characteristic creates a dilemma with significant policy implications, as efforts to advance innovation can simultaneously raise concerns about misuse.**" From here we can assume that statement II is correct.
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Reading Comprehension
Subtopic:)

Passage - 3

Every Indian student studying abroad represents a financial outflow of tuition fees, living expenses and long-term economic contributions. Host countries gain not only in revenue but also through greater campus diversity, stronger research capacity and workforce participation. International students also bring cultural and intellectual exchange that enriches academic ecosystems. India's failure to attract international students at scale means forfeiting these benefits while reinforcing its image as a source of talent rather than a destination for learning. India has two options. Either it continues to excel at exporting students while remaining largely invisible on the global education map, or it commits to building universities that attract learners from around the world. How it responds will shape not only its education system but also its place in the global knowledge economy for decades to come.

Q.54) Which one of the following statements best reflects the most rational, logical and practical message conveyed by the passage?
a) Greater campus diversity in educational institutions promotes intellectual dialogue.
b) When Indian students choose foreign destinations for higher education, the country suffers a loss of both human and economic capital.
c) India needs to improve its educational infrastructure to attract global talent and strengthen its knowledge-based economy.
d) India should position itself as a global hub for education in the coming decade.

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Statement a is incorrect. While the passage states "International students also bring cultural and intellectual exchange that enriches academic ecosystems", statement a does not best reflect the most rational, logical and practical message conveyed by the passage as it does not about India's position in the global knowledge economy.
Statement b is incorrect. The passage states "Every Indian student studying abroad represents a financial outflow of tuition fees, living expenses and long-term economic contributions. Host countries gain not only in revenue but also through greater campus diversity, stronger research capacity and workforce participation." However, statement b does not best reflect the most rational, logical and practical message conveyed by the passage as it does not state how could this issue be resolved.

Statement c is correct. It **best reflects the most rational, logical and practical message conveyed by the passage as it highlights how could India attract global talent and give a boost to knowledge-based economy.** It is mentioned in the passage as "it (needs to) commit to building universities that attract learners from around the world." It "will shape not only its education system but also its place in the global knowledge economy for decades to come."

Statement d is incorrect. While the passage states that India should position itself as a global hub for education, statement d does not best reflect the crux of the passage as it does not highlight what should India do in order to become a global hub for education.

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Reading Comprehension

Subtopic:)

Q.55) What is the rightmost digit preceding the zeros in the value of 20^{20}?

a) 2

b) 4

c) 6

d) 8

Ans) c

Exp) Option c is the correct answer.

$20^{20} = (2 * 10)^{20} = 2^{20} * 10^{20}$

As, powers of 10 will give only zeros at the end so digit before zeros is given by unit digit of 2^{20}

Unit digit in powers of 2 repeat in cycles of 4 ie 2, 4, 8, 6

We divide 20/4, the remainder is 0

Unit digit =6

Hence, the rightmost digit preceding the zeros = 6

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude

Subtopic:)

Q.56) The population of a colony of bacteria grows in Geometric Progression. On the third day, the population was recorded as exactly m, while on the 10th day it was found to be exactly 2m. If the population on the 9th day was n and that on the 100th day was kn, what is the value of k?

a) 8192

b) 2096

c) 3246

d) 5468

Ans) a

Exp) Option a is the correct answer.

Given:

• The bacterial population follows a Geometric Progression (G.P.)

• Population on Day 3 = m

• Population on Day 10 = 2m

• Population on Day 9 = n

• Population on Day 100 = kn

We need to find the value of k.

Represent the Geometric Progression

Let

• Population on Day 1 = a

• Common ratio = r

Thus the population on the tth day is a r^{t-1}

Use the Information for Day 3

Population on Day 3 = $a r^2$
Given $a r^2 = m$
Use the Information for Day 10
Population on **Day 10** = $a r^9$
Given $a r^9 = 2m$
Find the Common Ratio
Divide the two equations
$(a r^9) / (a r^2) = 2m / m$
$r^7 = 2$
Therefore $r = 2^{1/7}$
Population on Day 9
Population on **Day 9** = $a r^8$
Given $n = a r^8$
Population on Day 100
Population on **Day 100** = $a r^{99}$
Express Day 100 Population in Terms of n
We know $n = a r^8$
Divide the population expressions
$(a r^{99}) / (a r^8) = r^{91}$
Thus Population on Day 100 = $n r^{91}$
But the problem states
Population on Day 100 = kn
Therefore $k = r^{91}$
Substitute the Value of r
$r = 2^{1/7}$
Thus $k = (2^{1/7})^{91}$
Power multiplication gives $k = 2^{91/7}$
Since 91 : 7 = 13
Therefore $k = 2^{13}$
Final Value
$2^{13} = 8192$
k = 8192
Therefore, Option a is the correct answer.
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude
Subtopic:)

Q.57) What is the largest number which divides both $2^{35} - 1$ and $2^{91} - 1$?
a) 34
b) 90
c) 127
d) 129

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
By using the property of the highest common factor (HCF) for numbers of the form a^m-1 and a^n-1, we can find the largest number that divides both $2^{35} - 1$ and $2^{91} - 1$.
HCF of 35 and 91:

- The prime factors of 35 are 5×7.
- The prime factors of 91 are 7×13.
- The common factor is 7, so the HCF of 35 and 91 is 7

Calculate $2^{HCF(35,91)} - 1$
This becomes 2^7-1
$2^7=128$, so $2^7-1=127$.
Therefore, **the largest number that divides both $2^{35}-1$ and $2^{91}-1$ is 127.**
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude
Subtopic:)

Q.58) What is the difference between simple interest and compound interest on Rs.10,000 for two years at 20% per annum compounded half-yearly?
a) Rs.842
b) Rs.756
c) Rs.641
d) Rs.542

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Simple Interest (SI): (P ×R×T)/100
Where:
• P=10,000 (principal)
• R=20%
• T=2 years
SI = 10,000 × 20/100 × 2 = 4,000
Compound Interest (CI): P (1+R/n)n×t -P
n=2 (number of times interest is compounded per year)
Hence,
CI = 10000(1+20/200)4 −10000
After solving it, we'll get;
CI = 4,641
Difference between CI and SI = 4641 − 4000 = 641
Thus, the difference between simple interest and compound interest is Rs. 641
Subject:) CSAT
Topic:) Quantitative Aptitude
Subtopic:)

Q.59) The average age of the three sisters is 17 years. If the age of their brother is included, the average age of all four persons remains an odd number. What is the minimum possible age of the brother, given that his age is not less than 2 years?
a) 3 years
b) 5 years
c) 9 years
d) 13 years

Ans) c
Exp) Option c is the correct answer.
Given:
- The average age of the three sisters is 17 years.
- When the brother's age is included, the average of all four persons remains an **odd integer**.
- The brother's age cannot be less than 2 years.

Find the total age of the three sisters
- Total age of three sisters = 17 × 3 = 51 years

Determine the total age including the brother

- Let the brother's age be **x** years.
- Total age of four persons = 51 + x
- Average age = (51 + x) : 4
- Since the average age is an **odd integer**, (51 + x) must be divisible by 4 and the quotient must be an odd number.

Check possible sums divisible by 4

- Numbers greater than 51 divisible by 4: 52, 56, 60, ...
  1. 52 → Average = 52 : 4 = 13 (odd) → Brother's age = 52 – 51 = 1 year → Not valid (minimum age ≥ 2)
  2. 56 → Average = 56 : 4 = 14 → Not odd → Not valid
  3. 60 → Average = 60 : 4 = 15 (odd) → Brother's age = 60 – 51 = 9 years → Valid

Conclusion

- The **minimum possible age** of the brother satisfying all conditions is **9 years**.

Therefore, Option c is the correct answer.

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Logical and Verbal Reasoning

Subtopic:)

Q.60) A family of two generations consisting of six members P, Q, R, S, T and U has three males and three females. There are two married couples and two unmarried siblings. U is P's daughter and Q is R's mother-in-law. T is an unmarried male and S is a male. Which one of the following is correct?

a) R is U's husband.

b) R is S's wife.

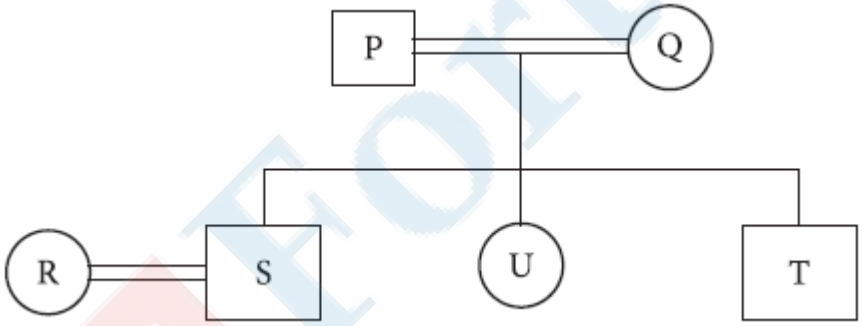
c) S is unmarried.

d) None of the above

Ans) b

Exp) Option b is the correct answer.

The family diagram drawn using the above given information is as shown below.



From the diagram, we can see that:

• P and Q are a married couple. P is Male and Q is female.

• U, S and T are the children of P and Q. Here, S and T are Male, and U is female.

• **R is wife of S**

• U and T are unmarried.

Subject:) CSAT

Topic:) Logical and Verbal Reasoning

Subtopic:)